

myOS

ISSUE 03

AUTUMN 2026

THE CALM ISSUE

20 Features for Autumn

Something Felt Off

THE ANATOMY OF A RECUT

The Psychology of Calm

WHAT THE EVIDENCE SUPPORTS

The Morning Edit

PLAN MY DAY, CLOSE THE DAY, THE
WEEKLY REVIEW

Five Decisions

AND THE ROADS NOT TAKEN

NO STREAKS. NO GUILT. NO
TELEMETRY.
PLAIN MARKDOWN · MACOS AND
LINUX

Today

Friday, September 25

About 3 h planned · 6 h available

🌙 Close the day

📅 Plan my day

Carried over 3

🔄 Re-plan

- ☐ Renew passport
📅 Sep 22
- ☐ Get a second quote for the countertops
📅 Sep 23 ● Kitchen renovation
- ☐ QA the onboarding flow on Linux
📅 Yesterday ⌚ ~1h ● Q4 launch plan

Today 6

- ☐ Choose the cabinet finish
⌚ after breakfast ⌚ ~30m ● Kitchen renovation #home
- ☐ Draft the launch announcement email
⌚ first thing, before Slack ⌚ ~1h 30m ● Q4 launch plan #launch
- ☐ Sketch the raised bed layout
⌚ after lunch ⌚ ~45m ● Spring garden beds #garden
- ☐ Spanish practice
⌚ with morning coffee ↺ Every weekday ⌚ ~15m ● Learn Spanish #spanish
- ☐ Empty the upper cabinets
📅 Kitchen week checklist ● Kitchen renovation
- ☐ Hold the sage sample next to the floor tiles
📅 Cabinet options ● Kitchen renovation

+ Add a task... (tomorrow, every tue, ~30m, #tag, @project)

Next steps 3

- Pick the November book for the club
Autumn reading + Make task
- Confirm the cabinet order with Dana
Kitchen renovation + Make task

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Letter from the Editor

Some issues begin with a trend. This one began with a feeling.

“Something feels off with the app and I’m not sure what it is.” That was the whole brief, and it is the most honest sentence in this magazine. Anyone who makes things knows it. The work is correct and still not right, and the gap between the two is where most of the craft lives.

In these pages you will read how myOS found that gap and closed it. Our cover story follows the overhaul from unease to diagnosis: a font that never loaded, labels too small and too faint to read comfortably, a notes app dressed up as a newspaper, a filing cabinet that asked you to choose a type and a domain before you had finished a thought. You will see the new silhouette, built on one typeface, warm neutrals, soft depth, a single accent, and one spring. You will find the five decisions that held it together, and a tour of the lining: the revision on every write, the one table, the Markdown writer that leaves your words where you put them.

Then we turn the page to the season ahead.

myOS 3.0 brings twenty features, and they were not chosen by instinct. They came from three research tracks: the market, walkthroughs of the app as three very different people, and the behavioral science of planning, memory, and motivation. Our essays on the market and on the psychology of calm tell you what that research found. “How We Chose Twenty” tells you what it cost to say no.

The features section that follows is organized as the plan is: tasks and planning, rituals and reflection, notes and knowledge, and files and trust. Repeating tasks that record

an honest “done 9 of the last 10 times”. A morning *Plan my day* and an evening *Close the day*. A journal, a weekly review, links that help, spaced recall of your own notes. Version history that keeps your folder clean.

Every one of them answers to eight written guardrails. No streaks. No guilt. Nudges only when you ask for them. Progress from real files. Rituals that end on what went well. Privacy by construction. Copy that is honest about the evidence. And your files, in your structure, untouched where you did not touch them.

It is still a folder of plain Markdown. There is still no account, no sync service, no telemetry, and no bundled AI.

We hope it fits.

The myOS Editors ■

BY THE MYOS EDITORS

“

Calm is not an absence of features. It is a discipline about which ones deserve your attention.

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Something Felt Off

It began with a feeling nobody could name. It ended with a notes and tasks app that finally sits still. This is the story of how myOS took itself apart and came back calm.

The brief was a single sentence, and it was not a specification. “Something feels off with the app and I’m not sure what it is.”

Anyone who has stood in front of a mirror in a jacket that fits on paper and wrong on the body knows the feeling. The measurements are all there. The cloth is good. And yet the whole thing pulls somewhere you cannot point to.

myOS, in its 1.x life, was a garment like that. It was already principled: a local-first Electron app for Markdown notes, tasks, and projects on macOS and Linux, including Omarchy and Hyprland, with no account, no sync, no telemetry, and no bundled AI. Its owner did not want to change any of that. They wanted something harder to spec. They wanted a world-class, lovely, consumer-friendly product, “almost Meta’s Muse-like”, built on elegant, modular code.

So before a line was rewritten, the app was sent for a fitting.

The fitting

Five reviewers, all of them agents, each took one angle: visual language, UI implementation, UX and information architecture, system architecture, and a live walkthrough that produced 46 screenshots. What came back was

not one flaw. It was a pattern of small ones, each defensible alone, which together explained the unease.

Start with the type, because the eye always does. The interface font, Geist Sans, was never loaded. On Linux the fallback chain quietly resolved to Liberation Sans, an Arial clone, which then sat beside carefully chosen serifs. Four typefaces competed on one screen. The dominant label was 10px uppercase monospace in tertiary ink, at about 3.3:1 contrast, below accessibility minimums. Behind it, the CSS held 34 distinct font sizes and 77 distinct pixel values.

Then there was the costume. The code and the copy were dressed as a newspaper: Daybook, masthead, ledger, an “In Play” lamp, stamp, plate, garnish, dateline, and the empty-state line “Nothing on the books”. The surfaces were nearly flat, stepping at about 1.06:1, and leaned on 0.5px hairlines to hold themselves apart. An Ultra Violet accent sat on cream paper and argued with it. The review had a name for it: paper-and-ink cosplay.

Underneath the costume was a filing cabinet. Eleven types multiplied by four domains decided where every file lived, so capture asked people to choose a type and a domain before they had finished a thought.

BY THE MYOS EDITORS

“

The measurements were all there. The cloth was good. And yet the whole thing pulled somewhere you could not point to.

Where they did not choose, keyword heuristics guessed: the word “book” sent an item to Personal. Explaining it all took a 20-entry glossary: Unfiled, Waiting, Refine, Process, In Play, Next, now line, The Record, sessions, Materials, Vitals, Dormant, and more. It was a developer’s filing cabinet, and it showed.

The promises that were not kept

Some of what felt off was simply untrue. Defer never hid anything. The Auto-save toggle was deliberately ignored. Notification history could be cleared but never viewed. The README advertised editor modes that did not exist. New projects wrote the literal placeholder “[What are you trying to change?]” into the user’s files.

And some of it was quietly dangerous. If a file was edited elsewhere, in vim or by a git pull, autosave overwrote the change without a word, because the editor reloaded only when a frontmatter date changed. Undoing a delete lost custom frontmatter and moved the file. The same list of fields was maintained by hand in about 12 places.

The code carried the same weight as the interface. A 3,659-line global stylesheet. A 1,005-line editor component with variants no one could reach. About 1,900 duplicated lines across five block editors, each with its own “Apply” button. IPC typed on one side only, with four error styles, 42 direct bridge calls across 15 files, and a renderer that could point the workspace root at any folder.

The glossary, retired

myOS 1.x needed a 20-entry glossary. Among the words it had to explain: *Unfiled, Waiting, Refine, Process, In Play, Next, now line, The Record, sessions, Materials, Vitals, Dormant.*

myOS 2.0 needs four nouns: **Note, Task, Project, Inbox**. The word “artifact” survives, but only inside the code.

The alteration

The response was not a new coat of paint. It was a recut, made in five recorded decisions (see “Five Decisions That Made 2.0” in this issue). The on-disk schema stayed, so existing folders, the CLI, and an external agent-tracking

tool kept working, but the product model shrank to four nouns. Every read and write began carrying a file revision. IPC became one typed table. The Chronicle design language was replaced by a warm, soft consumer system built on Inter. And styling collapsed into a single approach, Tailwind over primitives, enforced by lint.

The work was done in parallel. Specialist agents took the data core, the design system, the shell, the content surfaces, and the editor, each in its own git worktree, while an orchestrator wrote the contracts between them, merged, resolved conflicts, and handed the result to a final end-to-end QA agent.

After QA came two upgrades that nobody would see and everybody would feel. Untouched Markdown blocks are now written back byte for byte. Inline text like `Result<T>`, once swallowed as HTML on save, now stays exactly as typed. Both were checked against a copy of the owner’s real 82-note workspace: zero changes on open, zero collateral changes on edit.

Opening a page never rewrites its file. It is the least glamorous sentence in the product, and the one it is built on.

What it feels like now

Press `⌘N` from anywhere and type. Words like tomorrow, `#tag`, `@project`, or `!` are welcome and never required. Sort the Inbox one item at a time with single keys (T, N, P, D, `⌘`, `→`) until the screen says, simply, “Inbox zero. Nice.” Today gathers what is overdue, due, flagged, or in progress; completing a task ends in a small spring and a toast that reads “Done · Undo”. Notes are search-first. Projects gather a description, tasks, and notes. Every page edits its properties in place.

If a file changes under you, the page no longer pretends otherwise. It says “This page changed on disk” and offers two honest choices: *Load theirs* or *Keep mine*.

The numbers tell the rest in the language of tailoring: the cloth was taken in. Total source lines went from 42,197 to 17,200, down 59 percent. CSS went from 5,220 lines to 763.

Files over 400 lines went from 14 to one. Raw controls outside the design system went from 119 to zero.

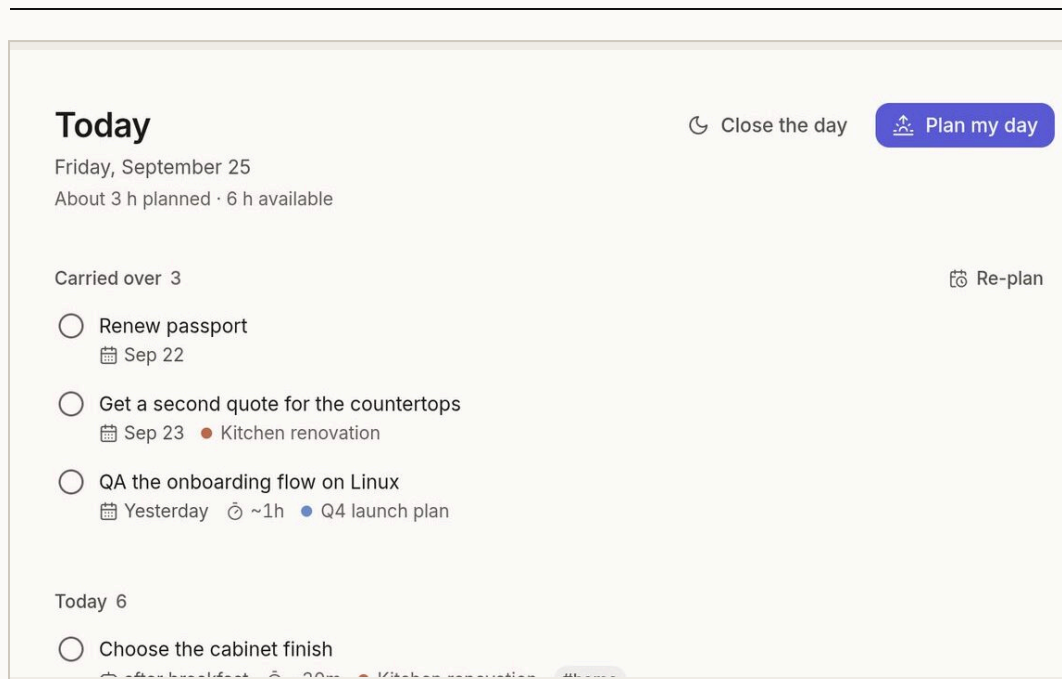
2.0, in one breath

Capture anything with ⌘N. Sort the Inbox one item at a time until "Inbox zero. Nice." Today shows what is overdue, due, flagged, or in progress. Complete a task, feel the spring, read "Done · Undo". Notes are search-first; projects gather a description, tasks, and notes. Light and dark themes, a choice of accents, and a serif reading option.

And now, 3.0

A calm product is not a finished one. The next season of myOS brings twenty features, chosen from three tracks of research: the market, persona walkthroughs, and behavioral science. They arrive under binding guardrails: no streaks, no guilt, opt-in nudges, honest progress, and privacy by construction.

The feeling that something was off has a name now, and a fix. What remains is the quieter pleasure of a thing that fits. ■



Today in 3.0, in the light theme: what is carried over, what is planned, and an honest line about the hours.

DESIGN

The New Silhouette

Out went the newsprint and the costume jewellery. In came one typeface, warm neutrals, soft depth, a single accent, and a spring you feel more than see. A close reading of the cloth, the cut, and the tailoring of myOS.

Every collection begins with a fabric decision, and the rest follows from how the cloth wants to fall. For myOS 2.0 the cloth is type.

The previous season wore four typefaces at once, with a 10px uppercase monospace label doing most of the talking. The new season wears one. **Inter Variable** is bundled with the app, so it arrives on every machine exactly as intended, with no fallback chain to betray it. It is set with its alternate forms switched on, `cv11`, `ss01`, and `ss03`, and its tracking tightens as it grows toward display sizes. It is the kind of detail nobody notices and everybody registers, like a hem finished by hand.

The design system states the principle in four words: use one voice.

The scale

The old CSS held 34 distinct font sizes. The new wardrobe holds seven, from 12 to 32, on a 14px base.

Twelve is for metadata and captions. Thirteen carries secondary interface text. Fourteen is the house default for rows, buttons, and inputs. Sixteen is the document body. Twenty titles a section, twenty-four titles a page, and thirty-two is reserved for a document's title and the rare hero moment. Weights are kept to three: 400, 500 for emphasis and labels, 600 for titles.

Section labels, once shouted in small capitals, now speak in `text-sm font-medium text-text-secondary`. Never uppercase.

Two accessories are permitted, each for a single occasion. **Literata**, a bundled serif, dresses the document body only when a reader chooses Appearance, then Reading font, then *Serif*. **Geist Mono** is for code blocks, inline code, and keyboard hints, and nothing else. Monospace went from the voice of the interface to a specialist's tool.

Warm, not cream

The old palette was paper and ink: cream stock and an Ultra Violet accent that clashed with it. The new neutrals are warm but clean. In light, the canvas is `#FCFBF9`, the sidebar one clear step deeper at `#F4F2EF`, raised cards and

overlays a true `#FFFFFF`, wells like code blocks `#F1EFEB`. In dark, the canvas drops to `#171716` and the surfaces climb in soft tone from there: `#1E1D1C`, `#252423`, `#2B2A28`, with wells at `#121211`.

Both themes are first-class. Every token has a light and a dark value, and they are reviewed together, like a garment fitted in daylight and again under evening light.

The ink is measured. Primary text reaches 14.8:1 against the light canvas and 12.1:1 against the dark. Even the quietest tertiary text clears 4.5:1 on every surface. The 10px label that once whispered at about 3.3:1 has no successor.

Depth instead of hairlines

The previous interface held its surfaces apart with 0.5px hairlines, because the surfaces themselves barely differed, stepping at about 1.06:1. It was all seams.

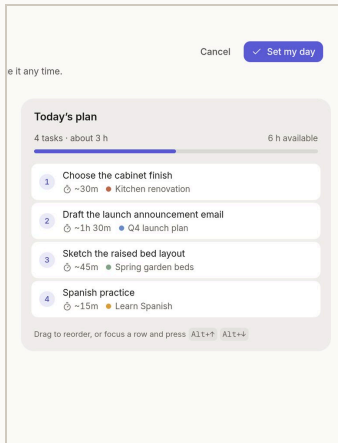
2.0 cuts with tone and shadow instead. There are three levels, canvas, raised, and floating, and three soft layered shadows to match: `--shadow-raised`, barely there under cards; `--shadow-overlay` for menus and popovers; `--shadow-dialog` for dialogs, which sit over a translucent scrim with a 2px blur. The dark theme leans more on tone than on shadow, as dark cloth does. Where a line is truly needed, it is a last resort, and it is always 1px.

It was all seams. Now the surfaces are held apart the way good tailoring holds a lapel: by structure, not by stitching you can see.

Shape is tailored to a grid. Spacing follows 4 points. Radii come in four sizes: 6 for chips and checkboxes, 10 for controls, inputs, and rows, 14 for cards and panels, 20 for dialogs and sheets, and a full pill where a pill belongs. Hit targets are generous, at least 32px for controls and 36px for list rows.

“

One typeface, used at a readable size. It is the most restrained sentence in the design system, and the most transforming.



One accent, Iris #5B5BD6, and soft depth in place of hairlines: Plan my day in the light theme.

The measurements

- **Type:** Inter Variable, 12 / 13 / 14 / 16 / 20 / 24 / 32, on a 14px base. Weights 400, 500, 600.
- **Reading:** Literata, optional. **Code:** Geist Mono, only.
- **Grid:** 4pt. **Radii:** 6 · 10 · 14 · 20.
- **Elevation:** raised, overlay, dialog.
- **Accent:** one `--accent`, default Iris #5B5BD6, ramp derived with `color-mix(in oklch, ...)`.
- **Motion:** 120ms, 200ms, 320ms, and one spring, `cubic-bezier(0.34, 1.4, 0.64, 1)`.
- **Contrast:** every text token at least 4.5:1.

One accent

Think of the accent as the single piece of colour in an otherwise tonal look. There is one variable, `--accent`, and every other accent value, hover, soft tint, text, is derived from it with `color-mix` in the OKLCH colour space. Change the one, and the whole ramp follows in key.

The default is **Iris**, #5B5BD6, which carries white text at 5.4:1. The accent fill is the same in both themes precisely so that white on accent always clears 4.5:1; any custom accent is darkened just enough to keep that promise, and `--accent-text` does the per-theme lightening. On Linux under Omarchy, the accent can follow the desktop theme. Project colours exist too, but they are decorative only: dots and covers, never meaning.

The spring

Movement is where calm software most often loses its composure. The rule here is that motion explains state. It is short and springy for delight, and never ambient or looping.

There are three durations: 120ms for hover, press, and colour; 200ms for popovers, selection, and a row arriving in a list; 320ms for dialogs, page transitions, and completion. Overlays scale up from 0.98 and fade in from their origin. And there is exactly one spring, `cubic-bezier(0.34, 1.4, 0.64, 1)`, reserved for two moments: checking off a task and creating something. Tick a task in Today and the circle gives a small, bright overshoot before settling, then the toast reads “Done · Undo”. A single

`prefers-reduced-motion` rule removes the transforms and keeps the fades.

The voice

A silhouette is also how a thing speaks. The costume vocabulary, Daybook, ledger, masthead, “In Play”, has gone. The design system names the words to use, Note, Task, Project, Inbox, Today, and the words never to use in the interface: artifact, vault, filing, domain.

The new voice is plain, warm, and in sentence case. Empty states invite rather than scold: “Your inbox is clear. Press `⌘N` to capture a thought.” A finished Inbox earns “Inbox zero. Nice.” and, beneath it, “Everything has a place. Enjoy the clear head.” A clear Today says “All clear for today.” Confirmations are short enough to read at a glance.

Wardrobe rules, enforced

Every control is cut from one pattern book, `dashboard/src/ui`: `Button`, `IconButton`, `Input`, `Select`, `Menu`, `Dialog`, `Checkbox` (the task circle), `Switch`, `DatePicker`, and friends. Lint forbids a raw `<button>`, `<input>`, `<textarea>`, or `<select>` anywhere else, and forbids hardcoded colours and arbitrary values outside that folder. Raw controls outside the design system went from 119 to zero.

The fit

Put it on and the effect is not of a design being noticed but of one receding. That is the first principle in the book: content is the hero. The interface steps back, one primary action per surface, and lets a folder of plain Markdown be the thing you look at.

The old look was a costume. The new one is simply well made. ■

5

DECISIONS

Five Decisions That Made 2.0

Great collections are defined as much by what the designer refuses as by what goes down the runway. The overhaul of myOS came down to five recorded choices. Here is each one: the problem it answered, the road it took, the road it left, and what it cost.

Each of these decisions was written down in the owner's own myOS workspace, as a Markdown file, in the same folder the app manages. Each record has four parts: context, decision, rationale, and consequences, and the rationale names the alternatives that were weighed. It is a small, fitting detail. The record of how the product was remade lives in the product, and the roads not taken below are quoted from it.

What follows is not a list of features. It is a list of commitments, the kind that make later choices easier because some things are simply settled.

1. Keep the files. Simplify the story.

The context. myOS 1.x filed everything by eleven types across four domains. Capture asked people to choose both. A 20-entry glossary explained the result. Yet underneath, those files were real, and people and tools depended on them: existing folders, the `myos` command-line tool, and an external agent-tracking tool that writes into the same workspace.

The choice. Keep the on-disk schema exactly as it was, and simplify only the product model. The interface now speaks four nouns: Note, Task, Project, Inbox. "Artifact" stays in the code only. Users never choose a folder, a

BY THE MYOS EDITORS

“

The simplification happened where people feel it, and nowhere they would be hurt by it.

domain, or a type directory; paths are derived. The `domain` field is still read and written for compatibility, but the interface never asks for it or shows it.

The roads not taken. The record names two. A new document type with a migration, which it calls “risky” because it would break the CLI and the tracking tool. And a full rename of “artifact” to “Doc” throughout the code: “large churn, no user value”. What the chosen road bought instead is listed just as plainly: zero migration, round-trip safety for user files and agent records, and no churn across more than 400 call sites.

The consequence. The simplification happened where people feel it and nowhere they would be hurt by it. Older typed files, decisions, meetings, research, and the rest, are simply Notes now, with their type shown as a subtle *kind* label.

2. Every write knows what it is replacing.

The context. In 1.x, if a file changed on disk, from vim or a git pull, autosave overwrote it silently. The editor reloaded only when a frontmatter date changed, so anything else slipped through.

The choice. Revision-checked writes and a conflict banner. Every read and write carries a file revision, written as `mtimeMs:size`. A save that arrives with a stale revision returns `CONFLICT`, and the page says: “This page changed on disk”, with two choices, *Load theirs* and *Keep mine*. The app recognizes its own saves by revision, not by timing.

The roads not taken. The record weighs two alternatives. Content hashing, fingerprinting every file, was rejected as slower on large workspaces. Last-write-wins, letting whichever save arrives last simply win, was rejected in one word: unsafe. The revision was chosen because it is “deterministic, cheap, needs no content hashing of every file”, and it retired the old timing-based autosave gate, the one that had mistaken real outside edits for the app’s own echo.

The consequence. If there are no unsaved local edits, a changed file reloads silently. If there are, you are asked. Nothing is overwritten until you choose.

3. One table for every conversation.

The context. The channel between the app’s interface and its file system was typed on one side only and spoke four different error styles. There were 42 direct bridge calls across 15 files, and the renderer could set the workspace root to any folder at all.

The choice. One typed IPC table. Every channel, its arguments, and its result live in a single contract. Errors come back as `Result<T>` with a small set of codes: `NOT_FOUND`, `CONFLICT`, `INVALID`, `OUTSIDE_WORKSPACE`, and `INTERNAL`. A generic preload exposes one allow-listed `invoke`. And the workspace can be chosen only through the native folder dialog.

The road not taken. Here the record lists no rival design, only reasons, and they read like a specification for trust: one place to add a channel, compile-time checks on both sides, stable error codes instead of matched error strings, and a smaller attack surface.

The consequence. Direct Electron bridge calls went from 42 in 15 files to 2 in one file. The interface can no longer wander outside the folder it was given.

The error vocabulary

Five codes cover every way a request to the file system can fail:

- `NOT_FOUND`: the file is not there.
- `CONFLICT`: the file changed since you read it.
- `INVALID`: the request does not make sense.
- `OUTSIDE_WORKSPACE`: the path leaves your folder.
- `INTERNAL`: something unexpected, reported honestly.

4. Replace the costume with clothes.

The context. The Chronicle design language dressed a notes app as a newspaper: Daybook, ledger, masthead, stamp. The interface font never loaded, so Linux users saw an Arial clone. Labels were 10px uppercase monospace at about 3.3:1 contrast. Surfaces were nearly flat and held apart by 0.5px hairlines. An Ultra Violet accent clashed with the cream.

The choice. Replace Chronicle entirely with a warm, soft consumer design system. Inter Variable is bundled, with Literata as an optional reading serif and Geist Mono for code only. A 12 to 32 type scale on a 14px base. Warm neutrals with three elevation levels. One `--accent` with an `OKLCH color-mix` ramp, defaulting to Iris, `#5B5BD6`. A 4pt grid, radii of 6, 10, 14, and 20, three motion tokens and one spring. Every text token at least 4.5:1.

The roads not taken. Two, according to the record. Refining Chronicle was rejected because it “keeps the root causes”: the metaphor itself was part of what felt off, and a better-made costume is still a costume. Geist Sans, the font the old interface had meant to load, was rejected as “more technical, less warm”. The rationale for the rest is practical: bundled, legible type fixes the biggest visual flaw, and depth made from tone and shadow reads well on non-retina Linux screens. Tokens are now written directly in CSS, which removed a code-generation step.

The consequence. Distinct CSS font sizes went from 34 to 10. CSS as a whole went from 5,220 lines to 763.

5. One way to dress a component.

The context. Two styling systems lived side by side: a 3,659-line global stylesheet in the features, and raw Tailwind carrying 288 arbitrary values in the editor and its blocks. There were 91 uses of `!important` and 119 raw controls outside any design system.

The choice. Tailwind, with primitives in `src/ui`, as the single styling approach, enforced

by lint. No raw buttons or inputs outside that folder. No hardcoded colours. No arbitrary values outside `src/ui`.

The road not taken. Per-feature CSS modules. The record dismisses them in three words: “still two systems”. The chosen approach offered one language, styles kept next to the components they dress, and primitives that enforce consistency on their own.

The consequence. Raw controls outside the design system: zero. `!important`: two. The rule lives in the linter, so it does not depend on anyone remembering it.

What the five have in common

Each decision moves a promise from intention into structure. The schema is kept by not touching it. Safety is kept by a revision on every write. The boundary is kept by one table and one dialog. The look is kept by tokens. The discipline is kept by lint. None of them relies on good behaviour to stay true.

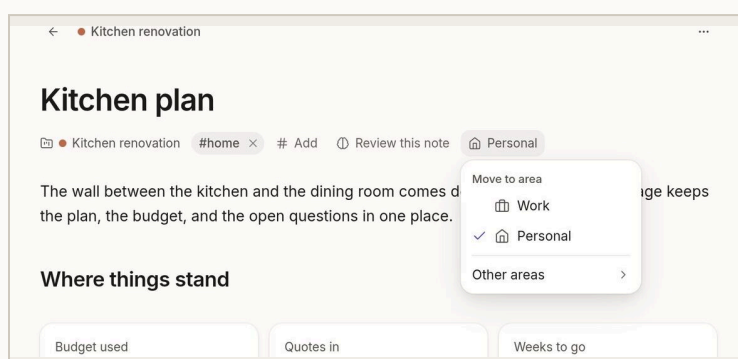
Afterword

Read together, the five decisions describe a temperament more than a plan. Keep what people rely on. Refuse to guess. Put the rules where they cannot be forgotten. Change the surface boldly once the ground beneath it is sound.

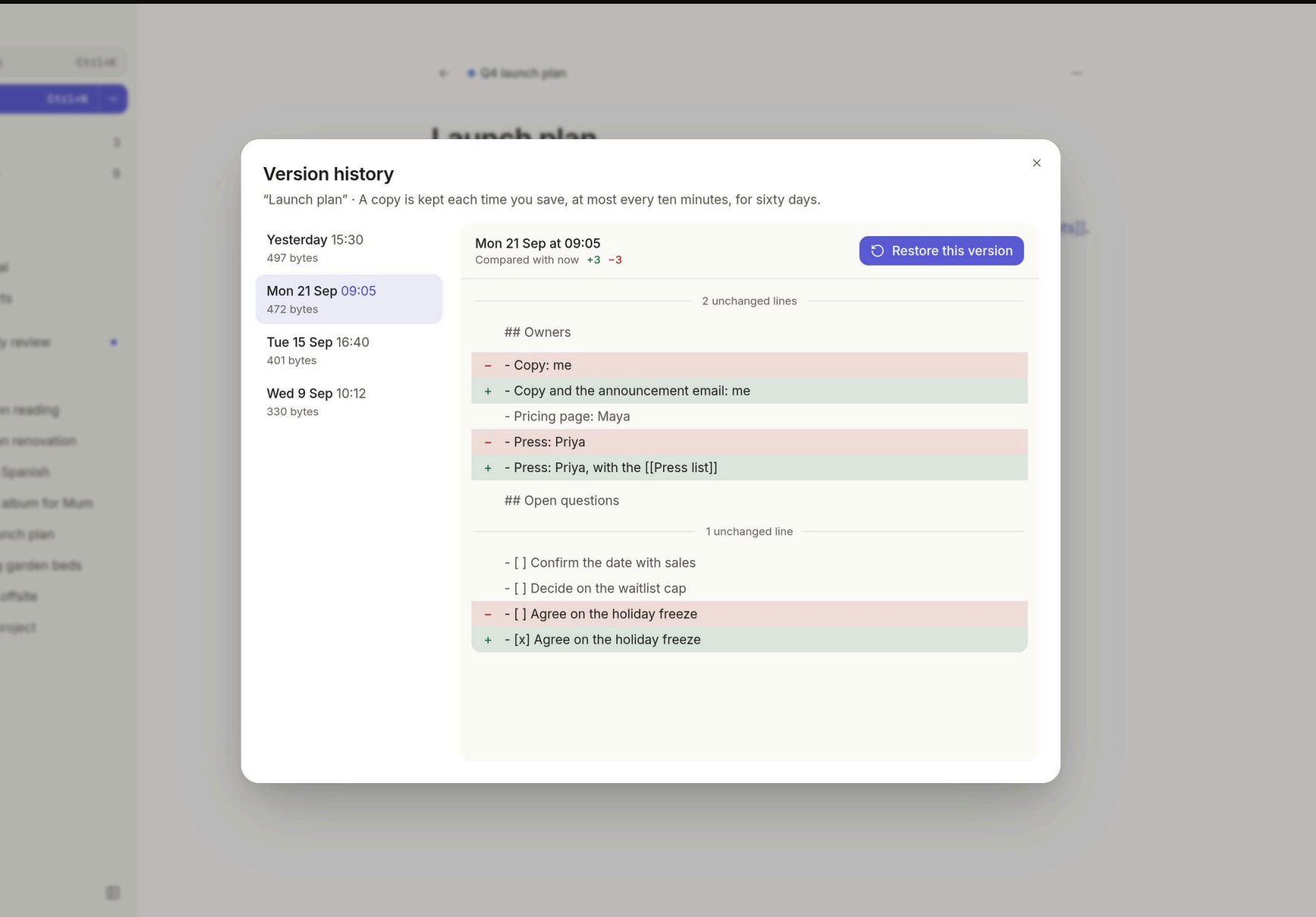
That temperament carries straight into 3.0, whose twenty features sit on this foundation and are held to the same kind of written rules: its guardrails. ■

“

A better-made costume is still a costume.



The domain field was kept on disk. In 3.0 it finally surfaces, as an Area you can change on any page.



Under the Hood

The calm you see is held up by a quieter kind of craft: a revision on every write, one table for every request, one list of fields, and a Markdown writer that leaves your words exactly where you put them. A tour of the lining.

In couture, the lining is where the real work hides. Nobody photographs it. Everybody feels it when it is wrong.

myOS 2.0 spent as much care on its lining as on its silhouette. The result is a product that is smaller, stricter, and far harder to hurt your files with. The overhaul removed 40,273 lines and added 14,861. What remained was not merely less. It was better arranged.

The shape of the thing

The app has three layers and one domain object. A selected folder of Markdown sits at the bottom, watched by the Electron main process. Above it, a shared layer holds the domain, the field schema, the IPC contract, and the rules for Today and capture. At the top, the interface: one data store, derived selectors, and a single gateway through which every write passes.

The domain object is the artifact: one Markdown file, YAML frontmatter plus a body. It is the only thing myOS persists. The word never reaches the screen. In the interface, artifacts are Notes, Tasks, Projects, and Inbox captures, and Task, Project, and Inbox are selectors over that one shape rather than separate stored things.

A revision on every write

The most important line of code in 2.0 is almost invisible. Every artifact carries `rev`, a file revision in the form `mtimeMs:size`, stamped

by the main process on every read and every write.

The editor keeps the `rev` it loaded. Autosave sends it back as `expectRev`. If the file on disk no longer matches, the save is refused with `CONFLICT`. When the watcher reports a new revision, the editor reloads silently if you have no unsaved edits, and shows the banner if you do: “This page changed on disk”, *Load theirs* or *Keep mine*.

The app knows its own saves because the returned revision matches, not because a save happened recently. Timing lies. Revisions do not.

One table

`shared/ipc/contracts.ts` is the single table of channels, argument types, and result types. In the main process, `handle(channel, impl)` is type-checked against it and wraps every result as `Result<T>`. The preload exposes one generic `invoke(channel, ...args)`, restricted to allow-listed channels. On the interface side, `src/data/ipc.ts` unwraps each result and throws an `IpcError` with one of five codes: `NOT_FOUND`, `CONFLICT`, `INVALID`, `OUTSIDE_WORKSPACE`, `INTERNAL`.

Every path the interface supplies is resolved by one function, `resolveInWorkspace()`, which follows real paths and symlinks and is used by every handler and by the app’s `myos://` asset protocol. The workspace itself can be set only through the native folder dialog or starter

BY THE MYOS EDITORS

“

*Timing lies.
Revisions do not.*

creation. Before, there were 42 direct bridge calls in 15 files. Now there are 2, in one file.

One field table

In 1.x, the list of frontmatter fields was maintained by hand in about 12 places. In 2.0 it lives in one table, `ARTIFACT_FIELDS`, in `shared/spec/`. That table drives parsing, serialization, the set of known keys, and undo snapshots. The per-type table of statuses, default status, and storage folder is data, and normalization and validation derive from it.

Anything the table does not recognize goes into `extra` and is written back unchanged. Your own frontmatter keys are yours. The frontmatter spec itself shrank from 734 lines to 201. Undo now restores exactly: the same path, the same frontmatter including custom keys, the same body.

The lining, itemized

- **Revision:** `mtimeMs:size` on every read and write; stale saves return `CONFLICT`.
- **Contract:** one IPC table, one allow-listed `invoke`, `Result<T>` everywhere.
- **Boundary:** every path through `resolveInWorkspace()`; the folder chosen only by native dialog.
- **Schema:** one `ARTIFACT_FIELDS` table; unknown keys round-trip through `extra`.
- **Writing:** untouched Markdown blocks written back byte for byte.
- **Network:** none required. No sync, authentication, telemetry, or model provider.

Leave my words alone

After the redesign passed QA, two further upgrades were made, both about respect.

The first is source-preserving Markdown. A rich-text editor reads Markdown into a document tree and, when it saves, writes Markdown back out. The usual consequence is that saving normalizes everything: your `*` bullets are restyled, your carefully aligned tables are re-spaced, your link definitions are rewritten. You edit one paragraph and the diff lights up the whole file.

myOS 2.0 now writes untouched blocks back byte for byte. The test for “untouched” is ProseMirror node identity: if a block in the document is the very same node that was

parsed from disk, its original source is reused. Only the blocks you actually changed are re-serialized. Opening a page never rewrites its file.

The second is a bug with a certain poetry to it. Inline text that looked like an HTML tag, such as `Result<T>` or `Array<string>`, was being parsed as HTML and silently dropped on save. The very type name at the heart of the new IPC design was the kind of text the editor used to eat. It is now kept as literal text.

The very type name at the heart of the new IPC design was the kind of text the editor used to eat.

Both upgrades were verified against a copy of the owner’s real 82-note workspace. Zero changes on open. Zero collateral changes on edit.

Many hands, one contract

The rebuild was done by parallel specialist agents, each working in its own isolated git worktree: one for the data core, one for the design system, one for the shell, one for the content surfaces, and one for the editor. An orchestrator wrote the contracts that let them work apart, the navigation URLs and the editor interface, then merged the branches, resolved the conflicts, and ran a final end-to-end QA agent.

When the boundaries are written down first, the pieces can be cut separately and still meet at the seams.

The `Editor` component is the clearest example of what that discipline produced. It went from 1,005 lines, with variants no one could reach, to 121. Five block editors that had shared about 1,900 duplicated lines, each with its own “Apply” button, now render as React node views through a shared frame.

Why it matters to someone who never reads code

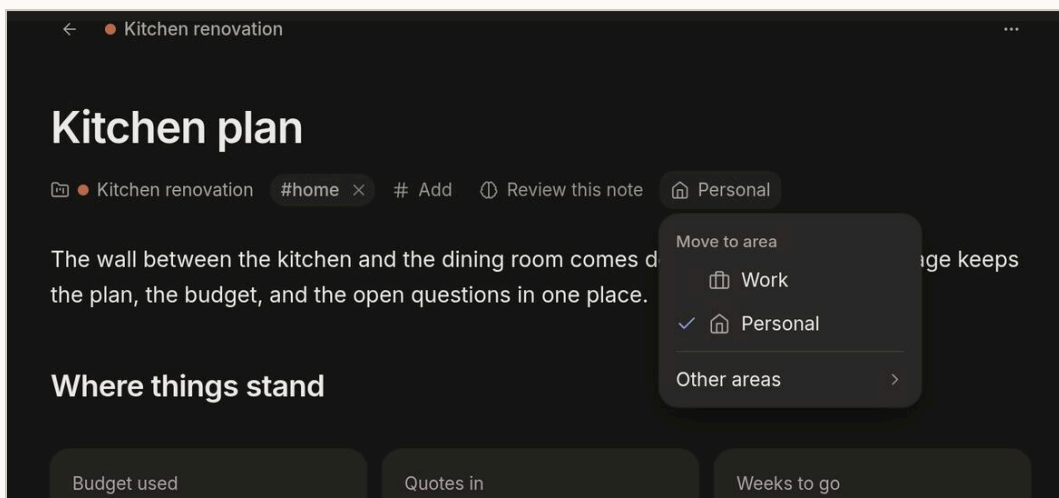
Because the lining decides how the garment behaves in the rain. You can edit a note in vim, pull changes with Git, or open the folder in another app, and myOS will not quietly undo

On fewer tests

The test suite shrank from 262 cases to 33. That is deliberate. The project keeps tests to critical invariants only: the things that must never break. Among them: a save made against a stale revision is rejected; a deleted file is restored byte for byte at the same path; editing one block rewrites only that block. Fewer tests, each one load-bearing.

your work. You can add your own frontmatter and it will survive. You can close the app for a decade and your files will be the same plain Markdown you left.

None of that is visible. All of it is the reason the calm is real. ■

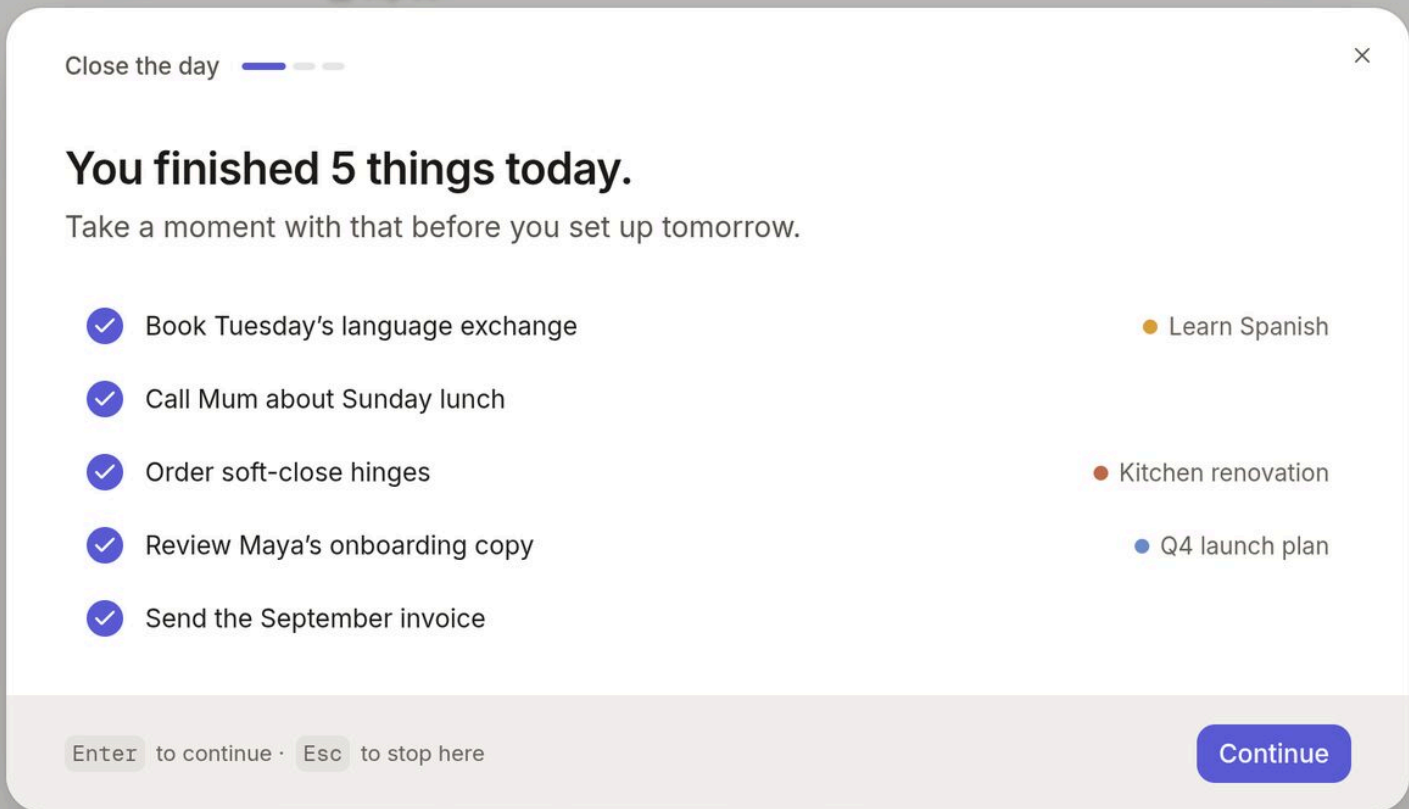


Moving a page to another area in 3.0 rests on the same foundation: the file keeps its name, a snapshot is taken first, and Undo puts it back.

By the *Numbers*

Every figure below compares the pre-redesign main (commit `e6e159e`) with 2.0. Before is myOS 1.x; after is 2.0.

MEASURE	BEFORE	AFTER
Total source lines	42,197	17,200 (-59%)
Files	318	236
Renderer (non-test)	24,440	12,151
CSS	5,220	763 (-85%)
Tests	4,547 lines / 262 cases	519 lines / 33 cases (only critical invariants)
Editor and rich blocks	9,079	4,175 (the <code>Editor</code> component went from 1,005 to 121 lines)
Renderer data layer	2,578	762
Frontmatter spec	734	201
Files over 400 lines	14	1
Raw controls outside the design system	119	0
Direct Electron bridge calls	42 in 15 files	2 in 1 file
<code>useEffect</code> / <code>useState</code>	97 / 197	40 / 63
<code>!important</code>	91	2
Distinct CSS font sizes	34	10
Diff	+14,861 / -40,273 lines	



SCIENCE

The Psychology of Calm

Productivity software has long borrowed from psychology, and not always its best ideas. For 3.0, myOS read the evidence first: what holds up, what quietly failed to replicate, and why the most humane feature is sometimes the one you decline to build.

There is a particular genre of app that congratulates you for seven days in a row and punishes you on the eighth. It lights a small flame, then threatens to put it out. It works, the way guilt works. It is not calm.

When myOS began planning its third season, one of the three research tracks was behavioral science. The brief was not to find levers. It was to find what the evidence actually supports, rate how strongly, and turn the answer into rules. What came back reads less

like a growth playbook and more like a code of manners.

What holds up

Implementation intentions. An “if-then” plan, *when X happens, I will do Y*, is among the sturdier findings in the field. The research brief cites an effect of $d = .65$ across 94 tests in Gollwitzer and Sheeran’s 2006 review, and notes that the figure is probably inflated; a 2024 update covering 642 tests gives $d = .27$ to $.66$, with larger effects for “if-then” wording

BY THE MYOS EDITORS

“

Capture alone is not enough. Capture plus a next step is what quiets the mind.

and plans that are rehearsed. The brief rates the evidence strong.

In 3.0 this becomes the quietest of features: an optional **When** cue on a task, “after lunch”, “at the café”, in the user’s own words, shown softly beneath the title. There are no reminders tied to it, and no “you missed it” message.

Plan-making. In lab studies by Masicampo and Baumeister (2011), writing a specific plan removed the intrusive thoughts and interference caused by unfinished goals. The brief rates this moderate: several studies, few independent replications. Its lesson is precise. Capture alone is not enough; capture plus a next step is what quiets the mind. Hence **Next step** on every project, one click from becoming a task.

Peak-end. People judge an experience mostly by its peak and its end; the brief cites $r \approx .58$ across 174 effect sizes (Alaybek, 2022), and rates it strong. So the rituals in 3.0 are built to end well. **Close the day** begins with what got done, then settles each unfinished item, then closes with “That’s a wrap.” The **Weekly review** ends on an optional reflection and a link to **What moved**, a plain list of what was finished and written that week.

Fresh starts. Goal-directed behaviour rises after temporal landmarks such as a new week, month, or birthday (Dai, Milkman and Riis, 2014). The brief rates the evidence moderate, mostly correlational field data, and suggests a weekly clean slate. In 3.0, a gentle “Weekly review” item appears in the sidebar only on the day you choose, and goes away once you have finished the review or dismissed it with “Not this week”.

Retrieval practice. Recalling beats rereading. The brief cites meta-analytic effects of $g \approx .50$ in one analysis and $.61$ to $.70$ in another, and notes that spaced practice helps retention; it rates the evidence strong. **Recall** in 3.0 lets you mark any note for spaced review at 1, 3, 7, 16, and 35 days, stretching or shrinking with your answer. It shows the title first, “What do you remember?”, before revealing the note. The queue caps at 10 a day, and the rest roll forward quietly.

Self-determination theory. Autonomy, competence, and relatedness predict lasting motivation and wellbeing (Peters, Calvo and Ryan, 2018). The brief treats SDT as a strong

framework, and it underwrites the first and most important guardrail: every nudge is opt-in, and explains *why* something is there, never *that you must*.

What does not

Ego depletion. The idea that willpower is a tank that drains through the day has a long shelf life in productivity writing. According to the brief, two large preregistered replications found effects near zero ($d = .04$; $N = 3,531$), and the famous “hungry judges” parole study has been reinterpreted as a case-ordering artefact. The brief’s instruction is blunt: don’t build features or copy on “willpower runs out.”

“21 days to form a habit.” The evidence the brief cites points elsewhere. In Lally’s 2010 study, automaticity took a median of 66 days, with a range of 18 to 254, and missing a single day did not derail it. A 2024 review found 59 to 335 days. Nothing there supports a 21-day rule, and so the phrase appears nowhere in myOS.

Unfinished tasks haunt you. A 2025 meta-analysis of 59 studies (Ghibellini and Meier) found almost no memory advantage for unfinished tasks, a recall ratio of 0.99, though it did find a reliable urge to return to interrupted work. The brief rates the memory claim contested. myOS will not tell you your open loops are haunting you. It will make them easy to pick back up.

Words myOS will not use

The 3.0 guardrails and the research brief call for evidence-honest copy. That rules out:

- “21 days to a habit”
- “Willpower runs out”
- Claims that unfinished tasks are remembered better
- Any promise of therapeutic benefit from journaling

“Mind like water” may stay, the brief says, as a metaphor, not a promise.

Why there are no streaks

A streak is a promise that turns into a threat. It counts up while you comply and resets to zero the moment life intervenes. The habit research cited above is the argument against it:

automaticity takes weeks to months, varies enormously between people, and survives a missed day. A mechanic that treats one missed day as total failure is, on this evidence, simply wrong.

So 3.0's **Repeating tasks** show a different sentence. Not a chain of flames, but an honest record: "Done 9 of the last 10 times." The dates behind it are stored plainly, as the last 30 completion dates in the task's own frontmatter. Miss a week and the count simply reflects it. Nothing resets, and nothing scolds.

The same reasoning renames a familiar word. "Overdue" becomes **Carried over**, in neutral styling with no red counts, next to a **Re-plan** action. The brief's argument, drawn from SDT, is that shame lowers the sense of autonomy and competence that motivation depends on. A task that slipped is not a failure. It is simply still here.

The guardrails

The research ended in rules, and the 3.0 plan made eight of them binding for every feature.

The humane design guardrails

- 1 **Autonomy first.** Every nudge is opt-in and can be switched off in one place.
- 2 **No loss framing.** No streaks, chains, badges, red aging counts, or guilt copy.
- 3 **Calm by default.** Only reminders the user sets make noise.
- 4 **Honest progress.** Progress comes from real files only. No fake head starts.
- 5 **Endings are features.** Rituals have a clear finish and end on what was accomplished.
- 6 **Private by construction.** Metrics are computed on demand from the files. No telemetry.
- 7 **Evidence-honest copy.** No "21 days" or "willpower runs out".
- 8 **Your files, your structure.** No placeholder text; no rewriting blocks you did not touch.

Two are worth dwelling on. *Honest progress* answers the goal-gradient effect: people speed up as they near a goal, and, as the brief notes, fake head-start progress works too, which makes it a manipulation risk. myOS computes progress from real files and nothing else. *Private by construction* means the app has

nowhere to send a metric even if it wanted to. There is no telemetry; anything stored is readable Markdown or frontmatter you can edit or delete.

The brief also proposes a test to run before anything ships: would this still be worth it if the user never opened the app more often? It is the right question for a calm app.

The shape of a humane app

Put together, the research describes a product that behaves like a good friend with a good memory. It helps you decide what to do and when. It lets you end the day on what went well. It gives Monday its sense of a fresh page. It helps you remember what you read. And when you skip a day, a review, or a whole week, it says nothing at all.

Leaving things alone always works. That, finally, is the psychology of calm. ■

“

Not a chain of flames, but an honest record: "Done 9 of the last 10 times."

garden

4 notes · 6 tasks · 1 project

Often with #spring #home

Tasks 4

Show 2 done

- ☐ Sketch the raised bed layout
 - 📌 after lunch 📅 Today ⌚ ~45m ● Spring garden beds #garden
- ☐ Plant the garlic
 - 📅 Sunday ⌚ ~45m ● Spring garden beds #garden #spring
- ☐ Water the herbs
 - 📌 before work 📅 Tuesday ↺ Every Tue ⌚ ~10m #garden #home
- ☐ Order the seed catalogue
 - 📅 Oct 5 ● Spring garden beds #garden #spring

Notes 4

- 📄 **What the garden taught me this year** 7h ago
 - The tomatoes did best where I paid them the least attention. The corner by the shed gets four hours of sun a...
- 📄 **Bed layout ideas** Sep 23
 - Two beds, 1.2 m by 2.4 m, with a path wide enough for the wheelbarrow. Peas on the fence side so they can...
- 📄 **Soil and compost** Sep 19
 - Two parts topsoil, one part compost, a handful of grit for drainage. See Bed layout ideas.
- 📄 **Companion planting** Sep 16
 - Marigolds draw aphids away from the beans. Basil next to tomatoes. Keep onions away from the peas; they sulk.

Projects 1

- Spring garden beds Sep 23

The Beautiful and the Open

Survey the notes and tasks apps of 2025 and 2026 and a pattern emerges. The calm ones live on Apple devices and keep your words in their own formats. The open ones keep your files and hand you a toolkit. myOS is betting on the space between.

Every season has its houses. In notes and tasks, they are familiar names, and for 3.0 the myOS research team read them the way a fashion editor reads the collections: what each is praised for, what its admirers complain about, what it costs, and, most importantly for this magazine, where it keeps your words.

What follows draws only on that market research, dated September 2026. Figures are as reported by the sources the research cites. Some of them, notably certain prices, come from secondary review sites, and the research itself flags those for spot-checking.

The calm houses

The most admired apps in this category share a temperament. **Things 3** runs a clean loop from Inbox to Today to Upcoming, and users praise it for being calm and a one-time purchase; the research cites a review from AsianEfficiency listing its complaints as Apple-only, no collaboration, and slow development, with a total of about \$80 across devices. **Bear** is loved for its beautiful editor and nested tags, and, per Toolradar, keeps notes in its own SQLite database rather than as files, with paid sync.

Agenda places notes on a timeline, and is Apple-only. **iA Writer** and **Ulysses** are prized for typography and focus, and are not task or project tools. **NotePlan** comes closest to a whole system on plain Markdown, joining daily notes, calendar, and tasks, and its reviewers note that it gets complex and is Apple-only.

The research compresses this into one line: the calm apps, Things, Bear, Agenda, NotePlan, iA Writer, are Apple-only and mostly lock data in their own formats.

Some calm houses have changed direction. According to the sources cited, **Craft**, once praised as the “prettiest notes app”, is now built around AI and MCP on a subscription, and **Amie** has pivoted toward an AI notetaker. **Sunsama**, whose whole reason for being, per ClickUp, is its guided morning plan and evening shutdown, costs \$16 a month with no free tier, and lives in the cloud.

The open houses

On the other side of the street are the apps built on open files. **Obsidian**, in the research’s words, is the largest local-Markdown community. Users praise it for owning their

BY THE MYOS EDITORS

“

The calm apps are Apple-only and mostly lock data in their own formats. The open apps are free but complicated.

files, its plugins, and Bases, its built-in database views. A Substack essay the research cites names the complaint: a “plugin rabbit hole”, more tweaking than writing.

The plugin charts, as tallied by *obsidianstats* as cumulative downloads, are a map of what people need and Obsidian does not ship: Excalidraw at 8.2 million, Templater at 5.7 million, Dataview at 5.0 million, Tasks at 4.3 million, Git at 3.2 million, Calendar at 3.1 million, Kanban at 2.7 million, Remotely Save at 2.3 million.

Logseq, the daily-journal outliner, has long been built on Markdown files. Per the Hacker News and forum discussions the research cites, its database version, in beta as of July 2026, makes the database, not Markdown, the source of truth. **Anytype** keeps data locally in an encrypted database; Toolradar’s review notes that its types and relations confuse people and that adding a tag takes many clicks. **Tana** is praised for structure, and, per a review on Saner, takes weeks to learn and is cloud-only.

What the plugin charts say

Cumulative Obsidian plugin downloads, as reported by *obsidianstats*:

PLUGIN	DOWNLOADS
Excalidraw	8.2M
Templater	5.7M
Dataview	5.0M
Tasks	4.3M
Git	3.2M
Calendar	3.1M
Kanban	2.7M
Remotely Save	2.3M

Read as a wish list, it asks for tasks, calendars, templates, history, and views, on top of plain files.

The cloud houses

Then there is the cloud. **Notion** is flexible; the sources the research cites describe it as slow, its offline mode as feeling “fake”, and its databases as exporting to CSV, which amounts to lock-in. **Todoist** has what reviewers call the best date parsing in the business, the research cites 2sync on this, with a reported price rise of about 40

percent in December 2025. **TickTick** puts tasks, calendar, habits, and Pomodoro in one inexpensive app, with weaker parsing of repeat rules. **Apple Notes** is free and everywhere on Apple devices, and, per MacRumors, gained Markdown import and export only with iOS 26.

The gap

Lay the houses side by side and a space appears that nobody occupies. The research states it plainly: no one offers calm, plain Markdown files, a strong task model, and Linux support together.

Linux is the sharpest edge of it. The research cites a usevoicy roundup finding Linux users left with Joplin or a heavily configured Obsidian. Things and Sunsama, the apps whose calm daily routines users praise, are Apple-only or cloud-only.

No one offers calm, plain Markdown files, a strong task model, and Linux support together.

myOS already stands in that space. It is a local-first app for macOS and Linux, including Omarchy and Hyprland. It keeps plain Markdown in a folder you choose. It has no account, no sync service, no telemetry, and no bundled AI. And since 2.0 it writes untouched blocks back byte for byte, which the research calls a technical moat. Its proposed line for this: “Your files will still open in 2046.”

Five openings

The research names several differentiating opportunities. Five of them shape 3.0.

A refuge from lock-in. With Logseq moving its source of truth to a database, Bear and Anytype on their own databases, and Notion’s exports described as lossy, a folder of plain Markdown is a quiet form of insurance.

Calm planning on plain files, on Linux. A Things- or Sunsama-style daily routine, running on your own files, on Linux, where the calm houses do not go. 3.0’s *Plan my day*, *Close the day*, and *Weekly review* answer this directly.

Obsidian without the plugin tax. Ship the behaviours of the most-downloaded plugins as a small set of built-in, opinionated defaults. 3.0 brings repeating tasks, a journal, templates, and version history into the app itself.

Friendly to Obsidian. Read and write the same conventions, so one folder works in both apps. In 3.0, a checklist line dated with the Obsidian Tasks  syntax appears in Today.

Privacy that is literal. No account and no network, rather than a policy asking you to trust someone's encryption.

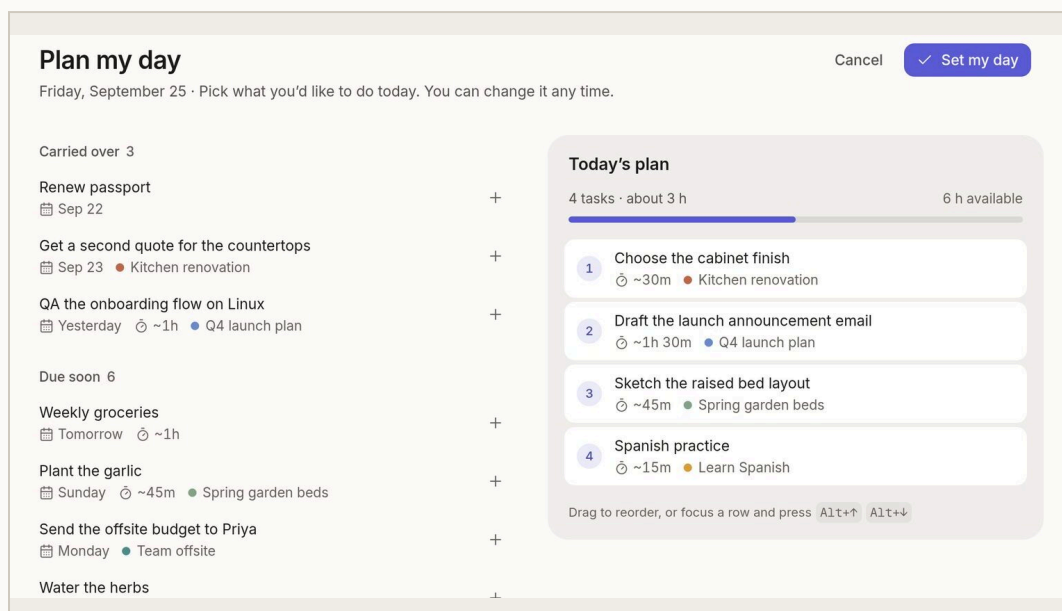
A note on the figures

All prices, download counts, and dates in this article are as reported by the sources cited in the myOS market research (September 2026). Download counts are cumulative, from obsidianstats. The research itself flags Todoist's exact post-increase price, Things' approximately \$80 total, and Notion's pricing as figures to spot-check. myOS makes no claims about any other product beyond what those sources report.

The collection that fits the gap

Fashion has a word for the piece that makes a wardrobe work: the one that goes with everything and draws no attention to itself. That, we would argue, is the role waiting for a notes and tasks app. Not the most powerful, not the most beautiful on one platform, but the calm one that keeps your files open and your desk clear on whatever machine you use.

That is the brief for 3.0. ■



Plan my day in 3.0: a calm morning routine on plain Markdown files, on Linux as well as macOS.

45

PROCESS

How We Chose Twenty

A season is edited, not accumulated. Three research tracks produced far more ideas than one release could hold. Here is how myOS narrowed them to twenty, what it found along the way, and what it left on the cutting-room floor.

BY THE MYOS EDITORS

Every collection has a moodboard that is larger than the collection. The discipline is in the edit.

For 3.0, the moodboard was three research documents, each written in September 2026 and each approaching the product from a different side. Between them they listed forty-five candidate features, many overlapping. The plan that emerged holds twenty. This is the story of the edit.

Three tracks

The market. The first track read the landscape: Obsidian and its most-downloaded plugins, Things, Todoist, Sunsama, NotePlan, Bear, Logseq, Tana, Anytype, and more. It asked what users praise, what they complain about, and where each app keeps its data. It produced

a list of table-stakes gaps and a list of differentiating opportunities.

The people. The second track ran the packaged 2.0 app with an isolated profile, started from “Start fresh”, and walked through it as three personas: a busy parent organizing a household, a student and researcher, and an indie developer. It scored what it found against Nielsen’s usability heuristics, by severity.

The mind. The third track read the behavioral science of planning, memory, and motivation, rating each finding by the strength of its evidence, and turned the result into humane design guardrails.

The finding that reordered everything

The persona walkthroughs produced one headline, and it was not flattering. myOS captured well. But a task with no date, no flag, and no project showed up nowhere.

The household organizer typed “Pay water bill !high”. The capture dialog promised the destination “Tasks”, a place that did not exist, and the task vanished. Today shows only what is due, flagged, or in progress, and there was no page listing all tasks. It turned up again only through ⌘K search. The walkthrough rated this a severity-4 problem, the highest on the scale, and named the consequence: tasks go in and cannot be re-found, and that breaks trust in the whole system. The research cites Bellotti and colleagues (CHI ‘04), who found that people manage tasks well when those tasks stay visible.

The same session found capture dropping words. “Soccer practice pickup every tuesday” became a one-time task titled “Soccer practice pickup every”. “Sam dentist on friday” became “Sam dentist on”. “Dentist for Sam fri @fam” got no date at all, because short weekday names only counted at the end of the line.

Those two findings set the order of the season. Feature 3, **Tasks: Anytime and Someday**, gives every task a visible home, and the plan says in so many words that it fixes “invisible tasks”. Feature 2, **Capture that understands you**, keeps meaning: weekdays recognized anywhere, stranded connector words trimmed, one rule for “next week”, and a destination that never names a place that does not exist.

The three personas, in one line each

- **The household organizer** saw family life filed under `work/`, lost words in capture, and lost a task entirely.
- **The student** found `[]` offered no suggestions, broken links looked like working ones, and tags could not be used to find anything.
- **The indie developer** found no next action on projects, no weekly review, and “next week” meaning two different dates.

Table stakes and differentiators

The market research drew a clear line between the two.

Table stakes are what people assume. Repeating tasks: every task app has them, the Obsidian Tasks plugin has 4.3 million downloads as reported by obsidianstats, and myOS already had a `repeatRule` field that did nothing. A daily note or journal. Export and share. Checkboxes inside notes that behave as real tasks. These became **Repeating tasks, Journal, Export and share**, and **Checklists become tasks**, the last of them compatible with the Obsidian Tasks `date` syntax.

Differentiators are what nobody else combines. The research named a calm, Sunsama-style daily routine on plain files, on Linux, as one of the clearest. That became **Plan my day, Close the day**, and the **Weekly review**. Its idea of “Obsidian without the plugin tax” shaped **Templates** and **Version history**, answering the demand behind the Templater and Git plugins with small built-in defaults.

The behavioral track then shaped how each of them behaves. It named its biggest wins: a next step on projects, a “when” cue on tasks, close the day, a softer Overdue, and recall for notes. All five are in the twenty.

The cutting-room floor

The harder part of the edit is what did not make it. The plan itself does not list its omissions, but the decision that adopted it does. Recorded in the owner’s myOS workspace as “Twenty features chosen from market, UX, and behavioral research”, it names four rejections and gives each a reason in a few words. Every one of them answers to the product’s own contract: local files, plain Markdown, no account, no network, no bundled AI.

A mobile companion. The market research calls a way onto the phone a table-stakes gap, noting that every competitor has a mobile story. The decision record rejects it anyway, for two reasons: it is the largest effort on the list, and it is “a separate product”, not a feature of this one.

“

Three documents, each approaching the product from a different side. The plan sits where they overlap.

“

*A season is edited,
not accumulated.*

Calendar URL subscriptions. A read-only calendar in Today appears in both the market and UX research. The record’s reason for leaving it out is a single word: network. A subscribed URL has to be fetched, and the 3.0 plan holds to no network.

Importers. Tools to bring notes in from Notion, Apple Notes, Bear, Things, and Todoist were rated medium to large effort, and the record judges them “lower leverage now”. The twenty chose instead to make myOS better at what it already reads: plain Markdown, and Obsidian’s conventions.

Gamification. This one was not a matter of effort. The record rejects streaks and gamification on “evidence and ethics”. The behavioral research found that streaks are wrong on the evidence, since habit formation takes weeks to months and survives a missed day, and that fake head-start progress works in a way that makes it a manipulation risk. The guardrails forbid streaks, chains, badges, and red aging counts outright. What remains is an honest line: “Done 9 of the last 10 times.”

The twenty, by section

- **Tasks and planning:** Repeating tasks · Capture that understands you · Tasks: Anytime and Someday · Checklists become tasks · Carried over, gently · Estimates and capacity · Next steps and “when” cues · Plan my day
- **Rituals and reflection:** Close the day · Weekly review · Journal · What moved
- **Notes and knowledge:** Links that help · Tags and filters · Recall · Templates · Focus mode
- **Files and trust:** Areas and readable files · Export and share · Version history

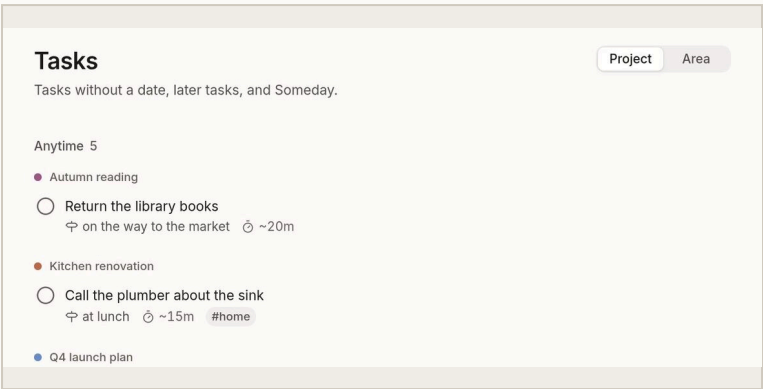
The test every feature passed

Every feature in the plan answers to eight binding guardrails, and the behavioral research adds one final question to ask before anything ships: would this still be worth it if the user never opened the app more often?

It is a demanding filter. It rules out anything whose value is attention rather than help. And it explains the shape of 3.0 better than any list: twenty features that make the app more useful, and none designed to make it harder to put down.

The making followed a second recorded decision: “Platform wave first, then four parallel surface agents.” Twenty features touch the same shared spec, selectors, and IPC, and parallel agents collide on shared files. So the first wave built all the storage, shared logic, IPC, and data hooks, and the contracts were reviewed once. Then four agents, each in its own worktree and each owning its own surfaces, built tasks and planning, rituals, notes and knowledge, and files and trust side by side, forbidden to change the spec or the IPC without coordination. A third wave ran end-to-end QA and polish in both themes. The fourth is the magazine in your hands.

The edit is done. The collection follows. ■



Tasks: Anytime and Someday. Every task now has a visible home.

*Would this still be worth
it if the user never opened
the app more often?*

THE TEST BEFORE ANYTHING SHIPS · FROM THE BEHAVIORAL RESEARCH

20

Twenty Features *for Autumn*

Chosen from research into the market, the people who use myOS, and the behavioral science of planning, memory, and motivation. Every one answers to eight written guardrails. No streaks. No guilt. Nudges only when you ask for them.

TASKS AND PLANNING

- 01 Repeating tasks
- 02 Capture that understands you
- 03 Tasks: Anytime and Someday
- 04 Checklists become tasks
- 05 Carried over, gently
- 06 Estimates and capacity
- 07 Next steps and “when” cues
- 08 Plan my day

NOTES AND KNOWLEDGE

- 13 Links that help
- 14 Tags and filters
- 15 Recall
- 16 Templates
- 17 Focus mode

RITUALS AND REFLECTION

- 09 Close the day
- 10 Weekly review
- 11 Journal
- 12 What moved

FILES AND TRUST

- 18 Areas and readable files
- 19 Export and share
- 20 Version history

Water the herbs

☐ To do

☒ Tuesday

☐ Defer

☐ Flag

☒ Every Tue

Done 9 of the last 10 times

☐ before work

☐ ~10m

☐ Project

#garden ☐

#home ☐

Basil, parsley, and the stubborn rosemary like to dry out between waterings; the basil never comes back.

The rosemary likes to dry

☐ Turn the pots toward the light

☐ Pinch out the basil flowers

☐ Top up the watering can for next time

Every day

Every weekday

☒ Every Tue

Every 2 weeks

Every month on the 29th

Every year

☐ Custom...

☒ Don't repeat

The Return

Some things come back every Tuesday. Now the task does too, and it keeps an honest record instead of a streak.

Every task app has repeating tasks. The market research called them table stakes: the Obsidian Tasks plugin alone has 4.3 million downloads, and myOS already stored a `repeatRule` field that did nothing at all. In 3.0 it finally does something.

Write the rule the way you would say it. Capture understands `every day`, `every weekday`, `every other week`, `every mon, thu`, and `every month on the 15th`. The row shows a quiet “Every Tue”. When you tick the task off, it does not disappear. The date goes into the file’s `completions` list, due

moves to the next occurrence, and the toast says so plainly: “Done · next Tue”. Undo reverses both changes at once.

What the page will never show is a streak. The behavioral research is clear that habits take weeks to months to form, with a median of 66 days in one study, and that a missed day does not derail them. A chain that resets to zero punishes the one thing that does not matter. So the page keeps a truthful line instead: “Done 9 of the last 10 times.”

The record is plain frontmatter in your own file, computed from real dates. Nothing is stored anywhere else.

No. 01

HOW TO

Type `every tue`, `every 2 weeks`, `every weekday`, or `every month on 15` in Quick Capture (`(%N)`), or set Repeat in the task’s properties.

OPPOSITE

A task’s Repeat menu: Every day, Every weekday, Every Tue, Every 2 weeks, Every month on the 29th, Every year, and Custom..., beside the line Done 9 of the last 10 times.

Today

Close the day

Plan my day

Sow the climbing peas tomorrow ~20m #garden @sp

×

Tomorrow

~20m

Spring garden beds

garden

Projects

Spring garden beds

Learn Spanish

→ Spring garden beds · Tomorrow

Shift+Enter new line

Cap

Get a second quote for the countertops

Sep 23 Kitchen renovation

QA the onboarding flow on Linux

Yesterday ~1h Q4 launch plan

Today 6

Choose the cabinet finish

after breakfast ~30m Kitchen renovation Home

Draft the launch announcement email

first thing, before Slack ~1h 30m Q4 launch plan Launch

Sketch the raised bed layout

after lunch ~45m Spring garden beds Garden

Spanish practice

with morning coffee Every weekday ~15m Learn Spanish Spanish

Empty the upper cabinets

Kitchen work checklist Kitchen renovation

Hold the sage sample next to the floor tiles

Cabinet options Kitchen renovation

+ Add a task... (tomorrow, every tue, ~30m, #tag, @project)

Next steps 3

Pick the November book for the club

Autumn reading

+ Make task

Confirm the cabinet order with Dana

Kitchen renovation

+ Make task

Every Word Kept

Type the way you think. Capture now keeps your meaning, trims the leftovers, and only ever names places that exist.

The persona walkthroughs found capture quietly losing words. “Soccer practice pickup every tuesday” became a one-time task called “Soccer practice pickup every”. “Sam dentist on friday” became “Sam dentist on”. A short weekday in the middle of a sentence was not recognized at all.

The 3.0 parser keeps meaning. Full weekday names count anywhere in the line. Short ones like `fri` count after “on”, “by”, or “next”, before a time, or at the end. When a date is lifted out, the connector word left stranded in front of it goes too. `next week` now means next Monday everywhere, in

capture and in every date menu. `~30m` or `~1h30m` sets an estimate, and `every tue` sets a repeat.

As you type `@` or `#`, suggestions appear from your projects and tags. An `@name` that matches nothing becomes a button: Create project “Name”.

Beneath the field, a line tells you where the thought will land: Inbox, Today, Tasks · Anytime, or a project and a day. It never names a place that does not exist. The walkthrough rated the old promise of a missing “Tasks” page a severity-4 problem, the highest on its scale. Now there is a Tasks page, and a destination you can trust.

No.

02

HOW TO

Press `%N` (`Ctrl+N` on Linux) anywhere. Add `tomorrow`, `fri`, `~30m`, `#tag`, `@project`, or `!` if you like. None of it is required.

OPPOSITE

Quick Capture reads a date, an estimate, and a project as you type, shows each one as a pill, and names the destination underneath.

myOS

SearchCtrl+K

NewCtrl+N

Inbox3

Today9

Tasks

Notes

Journal

Projects

Weekly review

Projects

Autumn reading

Kitchen renovation

Learn Spanish

Photo album for Mum

Q4 launch plan

Spring garden beds

Team offsite

New project

LIGHT

myOS

SearchCtrl+K

NewCtrl+N

Inbox3

Today9

Tasks

Notes

Journal

Projects

Weekly review

Projects

Autumn reading

Kitchen renovation

Learn Spanish

Photo album for Mum

Q4 launch plan

Spring garden beds

Team offsite

New project

DARK

Tasks

Tasks without a date, later tasks, and Someday.

ProjectArea

Anytime 5

- Autumn reading
- Return the library books

on the way to the market ~20m
- Kitchen renovation
- Call the plumber about the sink

at lunch ~15m #home
- Q4 launch plan
- Ask Priya for the press list
- Make slides for the launch all-hands

~2h #launch
- Team offsite
- Write the offsite agenda

~1h
- + Add a task... (no date needed)

Upcoming 5

Dated after this week.

- Autumn reading
- Host the book club

after dinner Oct 7
- Kitchen renovation
- Scan the kitchen receipts

Oct 11 ~15m
- Learn Spanish
- Watch a film in Spanish without subtitles

Sunday evening Oct 4 #spanish

Tasks

Tasks without a date, later tasks, and Someday.

ProjectArea

Anytime 5

- Autumn reading
- Return the library books

on the way to the market ~20m
- Kitchen renovation
- Call the plumber about the sink

at lunch ~15m #home
- Q4 launch plan
- Ask Priya for the press list
- Make slides for the launch all-hands

~2h #launch
- Team offsite
- Write the offsite agenda

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- + Add a task... (no date needed)

Upcoming 5

Dated after this week.

- Autumn reading
- Host the book club

after dinner Oct 7
- Kitchen renovation
- Scan the kitchen receipts

Oct 11 ~15m
- Learn Spanish
- Watch a film in Spanish without subtitles

Sunday evening Oct 4 #spanish

A Home for Everything

The most important feature of the season fixes the quietest failure of the last one. A task you write down can always be found again.

In 2.0, a task with no date, no flag, and no project showed up nowhere. Today lists only what is due, flagged, or in progress, and there was no page listing every task. A household organizer typed “Pay water bill !high” in the walkthrough and never saw it again, except through search. The research rated this the most severe problem it found, because tasks that go in and cannot be found break trust in the whole system. It cites Bellotti and colleagues (CHI ‘04): people manage tasks well when those tasks stay visible.

The new **Tasks** page, with the subtitle “Tasks without a date, later tasks, and Someday”, gives every open task a

visible home. **Anytime** holds tasks without a date. **Upcoming** holds tasks dated after this week. **Someday** holds what you have parked on purpose. You can group the list by Project or by Area.

Someday is a real decision, not a failure. The behavioral research notes that choosing to park something closes an open loop much as a plan does. Someday tasks stay out of Today and out of its count, and they come back with one click: Bring back from Someday.

No. 03

HOW TO

Choose Tasks in the sidebar, or press **⌘3** (**Ctrl+3**). Press **s** on any task row to park it in Someday.

OPPOSITE, LIGHT AND DARK

The Tasks page, grouped by project. Anytime holds tasks without a date, Upcoming holds tasks dated after this week, and Someday folds away.

Tasks 4

🔍 Show completed (3)

- ☐ Get a second quote for the countertops
📅 Sep 23
 - ☐ Choose the cabinet finish
🕒 after breakfast 📅 Today ⌚ ~30m #home
 - ☐ Scan the kitchen receipts
📅 Oct 11 ⌚ ~15m
 - ☐ Call the plumber about the sink
🕒 at lunch ⌚ ~15m #home
- + Add a task... (tomorrow, every tue, ~30m, #tag, @project)

From notes 5

Open checklist items in this project's notes. Checking one off ticks it in the note.

- ☐ Pick the cabinet finish (sage or oak)
📅 Kitchen plan
- ☐ Ask Dana about the pendant spacing
📅 Kitchen plan
- ☐ Hold the sage sample next to the floor tiles
📅 Today 📅 Cabinet options
- ☐ Empty the upper cabinets
📅 Today 📅 Kitchen week checklist
- ☐ Move the fridge to the dining room
📅 Monday 📅 Kitchen week checklist

No.

04

TASKS AND PLANNING CHECKLISTS BECOME TASKS

Small Boxes, Real Work

A checkbox written in a note is now a task in its own right, and ticking it off anywhere ticks it in the note.

People write lists where they think, which is usually inside a note. In 2.0 those lines were only text. In 3.0 every `- [ ]` line in any note is a real task.

Give a line a date, either the Obsidian Tasks style `2026-09-30` or a trailing due `2026-09-30`, and it appears in Today when it comes due, and in Today's Upcoming

section when it is close. If the note belongs to a project, every open checkbox in it also appears on that project's page under **From notes**: "Open checklist items in this project's notes. Checking one off ticks it in the note."

That last promise is the careful part. Ticking a line from Today or a project page makes a single-line edit to the source file, and

the edit is revision-checked. If the line has changed since the app last read it, nothing is written, and you are told: "That line changed in the note. Open it to check it off." Nothing else in the file moves. It is the guardrail *your files, your structure* at the scale of one character.

HOW TO

Write `- [ ] Order tiles 2026-09-30` (or end the line with `due 2026-09-30`) in any note. Dated lines appear in Today; open lines in a project's notes appear under From notes.

ABOVE

A project page gathers open checklist lines from its notes under From notes, beside its own tasks.

Re-plan carried over

Pick a new day for each task, or move them all at once. It's fine to leave something where it is.

Move all 3 to

☀ Today

📅 Tomorrow

📅 Next week

📅 Someday

📅 No date

Renew passport

Was due Sep 22

Move to ▾

Get a second quote for the countertops

Was due Sep 23 • Kitchen renovation

Move to ▾

QA the onboarding flow on Linux

Was due yesterday • Q4 launch plan

Move to ▾

Done

No.

05

TASKS AND PLANNING CARRIED OVER, GENTLY

Without the Red Ink

"Overdue" becomes Carried over. Neutral type, no red counts, and one calm way to give yesterday's plans a new day.

A red number that grows every morning is a small daily reprimand. The behavioral research traces why it backfires: shame lowers people's sense of autonomy and competence, which self-determination theory ties to lasting motivation. The guardrails put it bluntly: no red aging counts and no guilt copy.

So "Overdue" is now **Carried over**, set in the same neutral secondary colour as other quiet information. Beside it sits **Re-plan**, which opens a short batch dialog: "Pick a new day for each task, or move them all at once. It's fine to leave something where it is." Each row notes when it was due, and each can go

to Today, Tomorrow, Next week, Someday, or No date, one by one or all together.

When every task has somewhere to go, the dialog says so: "Everything has a new day." Dated checklist items keep their dates in their notes, and the dialog tells you so rather than rewriting them. Leaving everything alone is always allowed.

HOW TO

On Today, choose Re-plan beside Carried over, or run "Re-plan carried over" from the palette (⌘K).

ABOVE

Re-plan carried over. Pick a new day for each task, or move them all at once.

Today

Friday, September 25

About 3 h planned · 6 h available

 Plan my day

 Close the day

Carried over 3

 Re-plan

- ☐ Renew passport
 Sep 22
- ☐ Get a second quote for the countertops
 Sep 23 ● Kitchen renovation
- ☐ QA the onboarding flow on Linux
 Yesterday ⌚ ~1h ● Q4 launch plan

Today 6

No.

06

TASKS AND PLANNING ESTIMATES AND CAPACITY

About Three Hours

An honest line at the top of Today, set against the time you actually have. Information only. It never stops you.

Most of us plan days that could not fit in a week. The research calls it the planning fallacy, and it offers a modest remedy: breaking work into parts and estimating each gives longer and more accurate totals.

In 3.0, any task can carry an optional estimate. Type `~45m`, `~2h`, or `~1h30m` in capture, or pick from `~15m` to `~3h` in the

Estimate property. When at least one planned task has an estimate, Today's header adds a single line: "About 3 h planned · 6 h available."

The available figure is yours. Settings → Planning asks for your "Hours available on a typical day", with the gentle clarification "For focused work, not your whole day." The same group lets you switch the line off entirely.

The settings copy makes the promise explicit: "An honest look at how much is planned for today, next to the time you have. It never stops you adding more." There is no warning colour and no refusal. The line is there to inform your judgment, not to replace it.

HOW TO

Type `~45m` in capture, or choose Estimate in a task's properties. Set your hours in Settings → Planning.

ABOVE

Today's header. Under the date, the honest line: About 3 h planned · 6 h available.

- ☐ Choose the cabinet finish
🕒 after breakfast 🕒 ~30m 🟠 Kitchen renovation #home
 - ☐ Draft the launch announcement email
🕒 first thing, before Slack 🕒 ~1h 30m 🟢 Q4 launch plan #launch
 - ☐ Sketch the raised bed layout
🕒 after lunch 🕒 ~45m 🟢 Spring garden beds #garden
 - ☐ Spanish practice
🕒 with morning coffee 🔄 Every weekday 🕒 ~15m 🟡 Learn Spanish #spanish
 - ☐ Empty the upper cabinets
📅 Kitchen week checklist 🟠 Kitchen renovation
 - ☐ Hold the sage sample next to the floor tiles
📅 Cabinet options 🟠 Kitchen renovation
- + Add a task... (tomorrow, every tue, ~30m, #tag, @project)

Next steps 3

- 🟡 Pick the November book for the club Autumn reading + Make task
- 🟠 Confirm the cabinet order with Dana Kitchen renovation + Make task
- 🟡 Book a conversation class at the library Learn Spanish + Make task

No. 07

TASKS AND PLANNING NEXT STEPS AND "WHEN" CUES

After Lunch, at the Café

A project knows its very next step. A task can know when and where it happens. Two small fields with some of the best evidence behind them.

The behavioral research ranked these two among its biggest wins, because the evidence is strong.

Next step. Writing a specific plan removed intrusive thoughts about unfinished goals in lab studies by Masicampo and Baumeister (2011). Capture alone is not enough; capture plus a next step is what quiets the mind. Every project now has a **Next step** property,

"The very next thing to do". It shows on the project card, on the project page, and in Today under **Next steps**, where **Make task** turns it into a task in today's plan.

When. Implementation intentions, plans in an "if this, then that" form, produced an average effect of $d = .65$ across 94 tests, and between .27 and .66 in a 2024 update of 642. A task can now hold an optional **When** cue in

your own words, "after standup, at the café...", shown quietly under its title.

The hint beneath the field is the guardrail in one sentence: "A cue for when or where you'll do it. There are no reminders." Early research on cues suggests that "after X" anchors build habits better than timed reminders. There is no "you missed it" message, ever.

HOW TO

Open a project and fill in Next step, then choose Make task. On a task, fill in When.

ABOVE

Next steps on Today. Each project's next step waits with a one-click Make task.

Plan my day

Cancel

✓ Set my day

Friday, September 25 · Pick what you'd like to do today. You can change it any time.

Carried over 3

Renew passport

📅 Sep 22

+

Get a second quote for the countertops

📅 Sep 23 ● Kitchen renovation

+

QA the onboarding flow on Linux

📅 Yesterday ⌚ ~1h ● Q4 launch plan

+

Due soon 6

Weekly groceries

📅 Tomorrow ⌚ ~1h

+

Plant the garlic

📅 Sunday ⌚ ~45m ● Spring garden beds

+

Send the offsite budget to Priya

📅 Monday ● Team offsite

+

Water the herbs

📅 Tuesday ⌚ ~10m

+

Pay the rent

📅 Thursday

+

Plan Sam's birthday dinner

📅 Thursday

+

Anytime 5

Ask Priya for the press list

● Q4 launch plan

+

Call the plumber about the sink

⌚ ~15m ● Kitchen renovation

+

Make slides for the launch all-hands

⌚ ~2h ● Q4 launch plan

+

Return the library books

.

Today's plan

4 tasks · about 3 h

6 h available

1

Choose the cabinet finish

⌚ ~30m ● Kitchen renovation

2

Draft the launch announcement email

⌚ ~1h 30m ● Q4 launch plan

3

Sketch the raised bed layout

⌚ ~45m ● Spring garden beds

4

Spanish practice

⌚ ~15m ● Learn Spanish

Drag to reorder, or focus a row and press `Alt+↑` `Alt+↓`

The Morning Edit

A calm, deliberate few minutes at the start of the day. Choose from the left, arrange on the right, and begin.

The market research found one opening clearer than the rest: the calm, guided daily routine that Sunsama charges \$16 a month for, and that nobody offers on plain files on Linux. Plan my day is myOS's answer.

It opens with the date and one line: "Pick what you'd like to do today. You can change it any time." On the left, candidates arrive in groups: Carried over, Due soon, Flagged, In progress, Anytime, and Next steps from your projects. On the right, **Today's plan** fills as you pick, with a running estimate against your available hours.

Drag to reorder, or focus a row and press `⌘↑` and `⌘↓`. Picking a task writes **planned** into its file; the order you choose is kept too. **Set my day** ends the flow with "Your day is set", and Today lists the plan in your order.

Before three in the afternoon, Plan my day is the leading button on Today; after that, Close the day takes its place. Neither ever opens on its own. And if the plan is empty, the app says what the research would: "A day with nothing planned is a fine day too."

No. 08

HOW TO

Choose Plan my day in Today's header, or run it from the palette (`⌘K`). On any task row, `⌘` plans it for today.

OPPOSITE

Plan my day. Candidates on the left; today's plan, its running estimate, and your available hours on the right.

Today

Friday, September 25

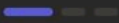
About 3 h planned - 6 h available

 Plan my day

 Close the day

Carried over 3

☐ Renew passport
@ Sep 22

Close the day 

×

You finished 5 things today.

Take a moment with that before you set up tomorrow.

- ☒ Book Tuesday's language exchange
- ☒ Call Mum about Sunday lunch
- ☒ Order soft-close hinges
- ☒ Review Maya's onboarding copy
- ☒ Send the September invoice
- ☐ Learn Spanish
- ☐ Kitchen renovation
- ☐ Q4 launch plan

 to continue ·  to stop here

Continue

That's a Wrap

Two minutes in the evening that begin with what you did, settle what you didn't, and end the day on purpose.

People judge an experience largely by its peak and its end. The behavioral research rates this peak-end effect as strong, with a correlation of about .58 across 174 effect sizes. Most productivity software ends the day on the backlog. Close the day ends it on what you finished.

The first screen counts it: "You finished 5 things today. Take a moment with that before you set up tomorrow." On a lighter day it says, "A quieter day. Not every day is for finishing things."

Then comes "Where should the rest go?" Each task still open for today gets **Tomorrow**, **Later**, **Someday**, or **Keep**,

one key each. Giving loose ends a place clears what the research calls attention residue, the leftover pull of an unfinished task.

Next, an optional line for today's journal page, appended under **Evening**: "A small win, a good conversation, a thought for tomorrow..." Leave it empty to skip.

It closes with a summary of what was settled and a finish line: "That's a wrap. The day is closed. Tomorrow can start fresh." Enter continues, Escape stops wherever you are, and the flow only ever starts when you start it.

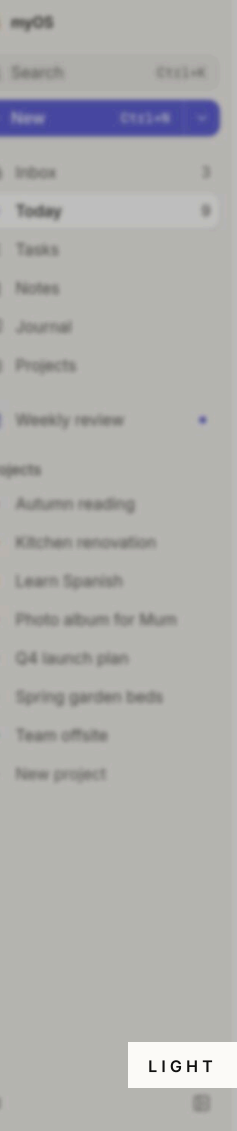
No. 09

HOW TO

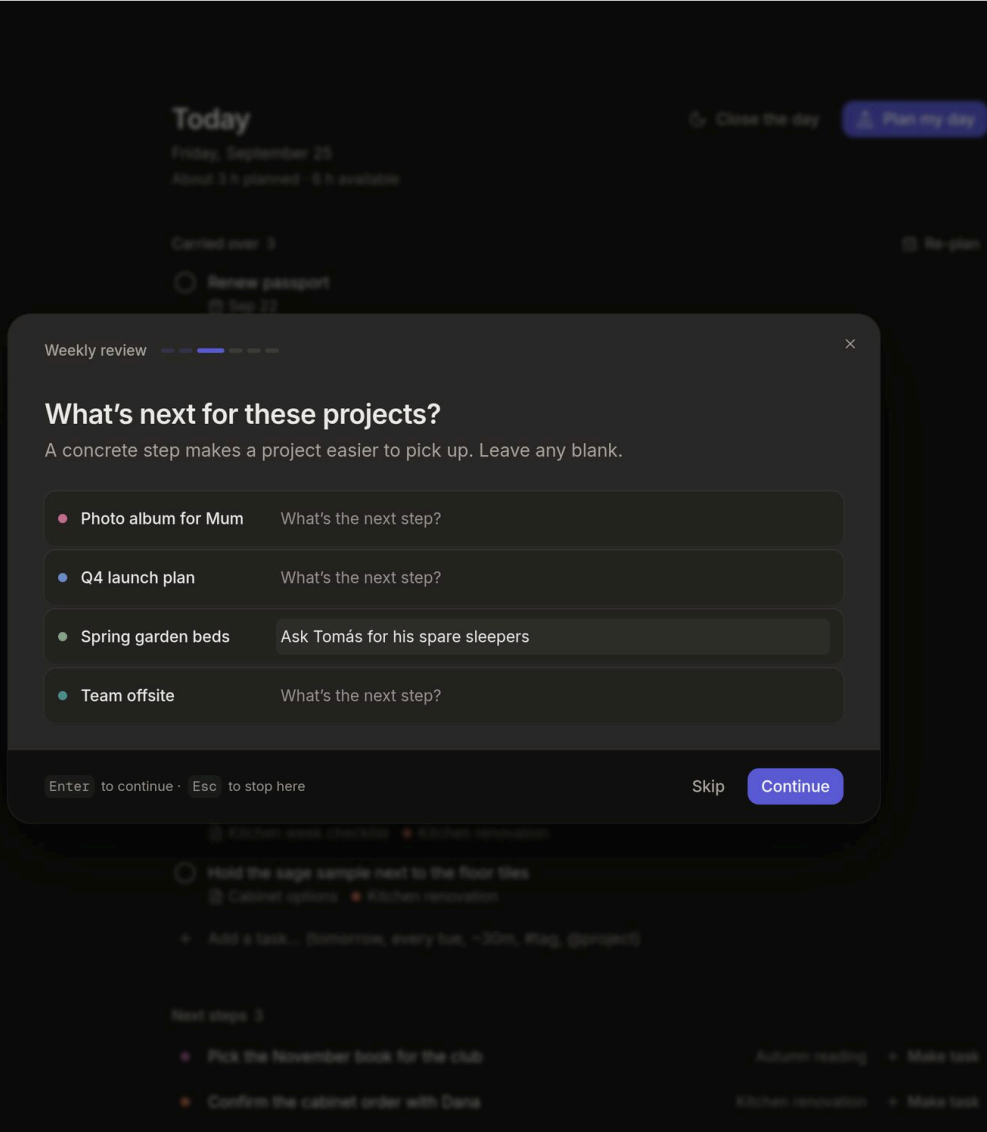
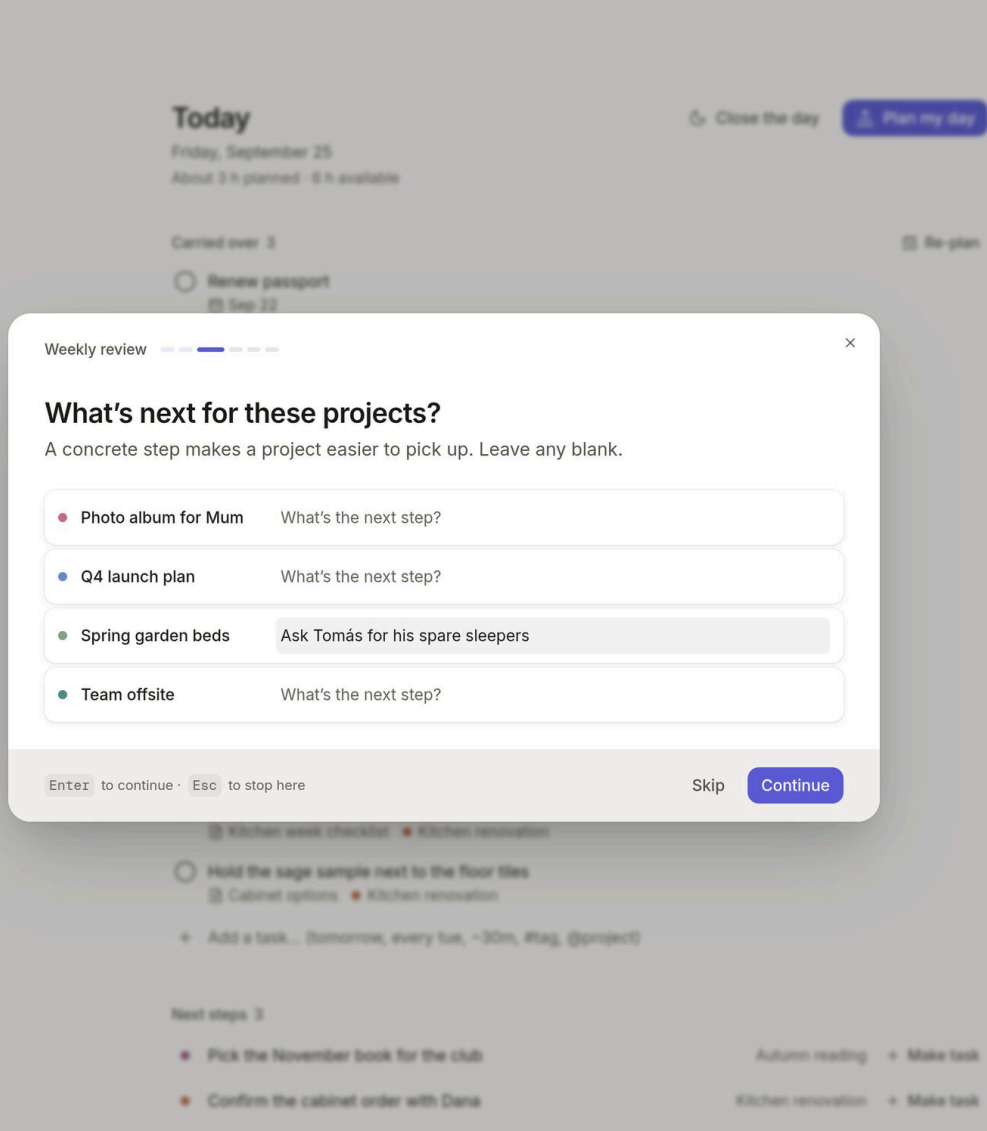
Choose Close the day in Today's header (it leads after 3 pm), in the Journal header, or from the palette (). It never starts by itself.

OPPOSITE

The first step of Close the day. "You finished 5 things today. Take a moment with that before you set up tomorrow."



LIGHT



DARK

A Fresh Week

A short, guided review that clears the decks without counting your sins. It appears once, on the day you choose, and then gets out of the way.

Researchers have found that goal-directed behaviour rises after temporal landmarks, such as a new week or month. The effect is moderate and the evidence mostly correlational, but it points at a humane idea: offer a clean slate at the moments people already feel one. The persona walkthroughs found myOS had no weekly review at all.

The 3.0 review follows the familiar Getting Things Done sequence in six steps. Start with the Inbox. Give carried-over tasks a new home. Answer “What’s next for these projects?” for any project without a next step. Decide about projects

quiet for three weeks: “That’s fine. Keep them, park them in Someday, or call them done.” Glance at Someday, where “nothing to do here unless something feels ready”. Then, if you like, write a few words for today’s journal page, under Weekly review.

It ends on “Ready for a fresh week.” and a summary of what moved, with a link to **See what moved**.

On your chosen day a small “Weekly review” item appears in the sidebar. It stays until you finish the review or choose **Not this week**, and a switch in Settings hides it for good. It is never a badge and never a count.

No. 10

HOW TO

On your review day (Settings → Rituals and journal; Friday by default) choose Weekly review in the sidebar, or run it from the palette () any day.

OPPOSITE, LIGHT AND DARK

The review's third step asks what's next for each project that lacks a next step. “Leave any blank.”

Journal

🌙 Close the day

A page for each day. Write as much or as little as you like.

Today Friday, September 25

Walked to the market before work. Figs are back, and the man at the bread stall remembered my name.

Morning

- Dana wants to see the sage green in daylight before we order.
- The launch email opening finally sounds like us.

September

< >

T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30
				•			•			•			•		•		•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•					

September

No. 11

RITUALS AND REFLECTION JOURNAL

A Page a Day

One plain Markdown page for each day, created only when you start to write. No prompts to keep up, no chain to break.

A daily note is one of the most common habits among people who keep their notes in files. The market research found it in Obsidian's core plugins, in the Calendar plugin's 3.1 million downloads, and at the centre of Reflect, Logseq, and NotePlan. myOS 3.0 adds its own, as one page per day at `journal/YYYY-MM-DD.md`.

The page is headed "A page for each day. Write as much or as little as you like." Today's entry waits with "What's on your mind today?", and the file is written only when you type the first key. Close the day and the Weekly review add their lines to the same page, under Evening and Weekly review.

A small month strip marks the days that have a page with a single dot. There are no

connecting lines and no counts, because the guardrails rule out chains of any kind. Journal pages stay out of the Notes list unless you choose Journal in the Kind filter.

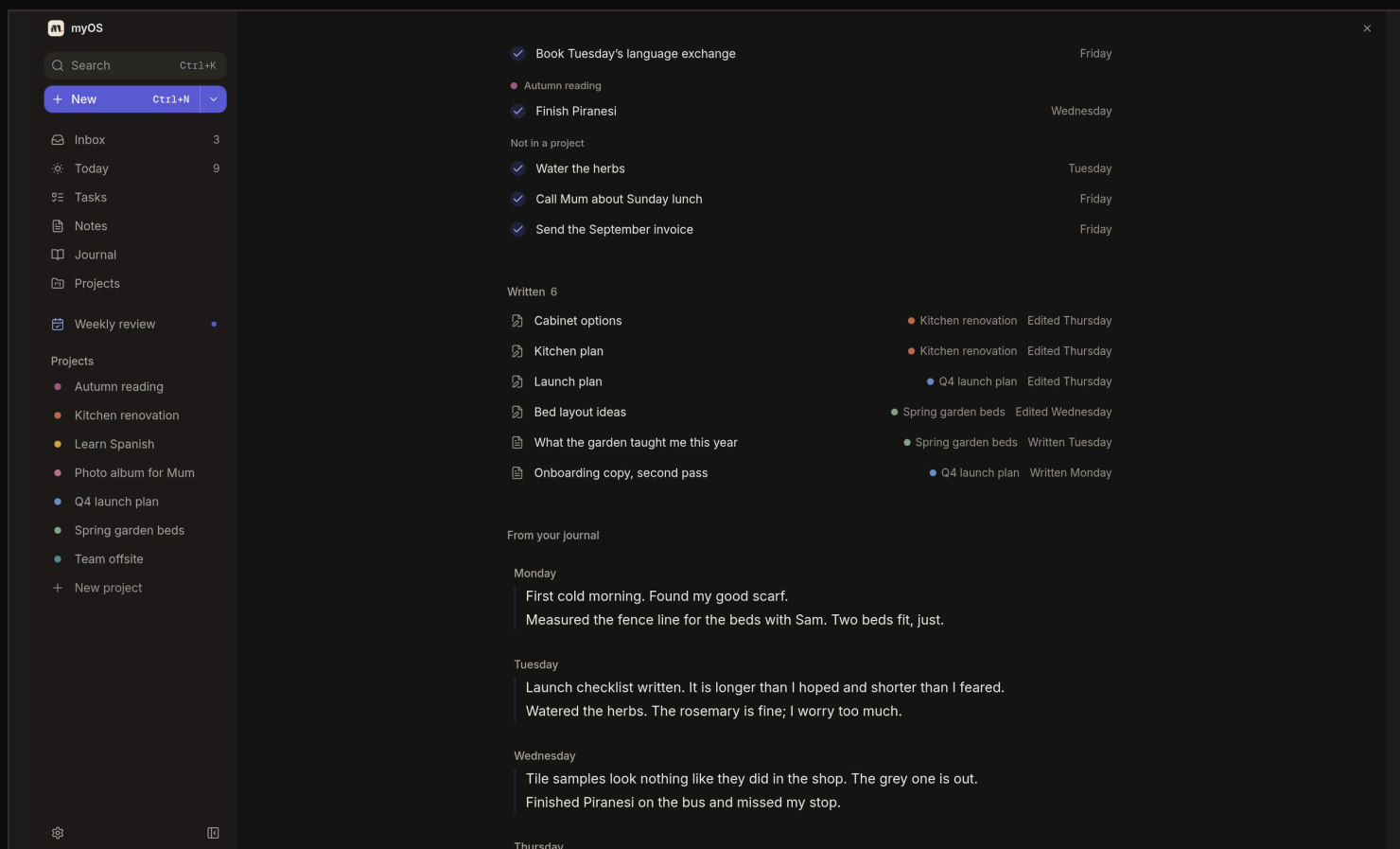
The research on expressive writing finds a small but real benefit, and the guardrails ask for evidence-honest copy. So the Journal promises nothing. It is simply a private place to write.

HOW TO

Choose Journal in the sidebar, press `⌘5` (`Ctrl+5`), or run "Open journal" from the palette.

ABOVE

The Journal. Today's page at the top, the month strip beneath, earlier days below.



No. 12

RITUALS AND REFLECTION WHAT MOVED

The Week, in Things Done

A look back at your week in finished tasks, written notes, and journal lines. A list, not a score, and never a comparison.

In a study of about 12,000 work-diary entries, small steps forward on meaningful work were the strongest driver of good days. The behavioral research rates that progress principle as moderate evidence, and draws a careful conclusion from it: make finished work visible and meaningful, not gamified.

What moved is that conclusion as a page. It shows one week, Monday to Sunday.

Finished lists the tasks you completed, grouped by project. **Written** lists the notes you wrote or edited, each marked with its day. **From your journal** gathers a few lines from each day's page. Previous week and Next week step through time.

There is no chart and no score, and there is deliberately no comparison between weeks. A week is not a race against the one before it. The empty states hold to the same spirit:

"This week is just getting going." For a past week with nothing recorded: "A quiet week on paper. Nothing was finished or written here that week. Rest and thinking count too."

Everything on the page is computed on demand from your files. Nothing is tallied or stored.

HOW TO

Choose See what moved at the end of the Weekly review, or run "What moved" from the palette ().

ABOVE

What moved, for this week. Finished tasks grouped by project, then Written, then lines From your journal.

Bed layout ideas

Two beds, 1.2 m by 2.4 m, with a path wide enough for the wheelbarrow. Peas on the side so they can climb. Mix in plenty of `[[comp`

What I still need is on the `[[Seed swap`

- ☐ Ask Tomás next door for his spare s
- ☐ Line the beds with cardboard before
- ☒ ~~Measure the fence line~~

Link to

📄 Companion planting	Note
🕒 Order two bags of compost	Task
📄 Soil and compost	Note
📄 Launch retro prompts	Note
📄 Create "comp"	

Linked from 1

📄 Soil and compost

The Connective Thread

Links you can find, links that show when they lead nowhere yet, and mentions you can turn into links with one click.

The student in the persona walkthroughs found the links half-finished. Typing `[]` offered no suggestions, and a link to a page that did not exist looked exactly like one that did.

In 3.0, `[]` opens a small menu of pages as you type. Matches rank from exact, to prefix, to word start, down to loose letters in order, so “wkrv” can still find “Weekly review”, and ties go to what you opened last. When nothing fits, the last row reads Create “...”.

A link to a page that does not exist yet is drawn dashed and muted, with the hint Create “...” on hover. Click it, and the note is created and opened.

At the foot of every page, **Linked from** lists the pages that point here. **Unlinked mentions** lists other notes that use this page’s title as plain text. Beside each sits a single **Link** button. It rewrites only that occurrence, checks the file’s revision first, and can be undone in one step. If the text has moved on in the meantime, the app writes nothing and tells you: “That mention has changed. Nothing was linked.”

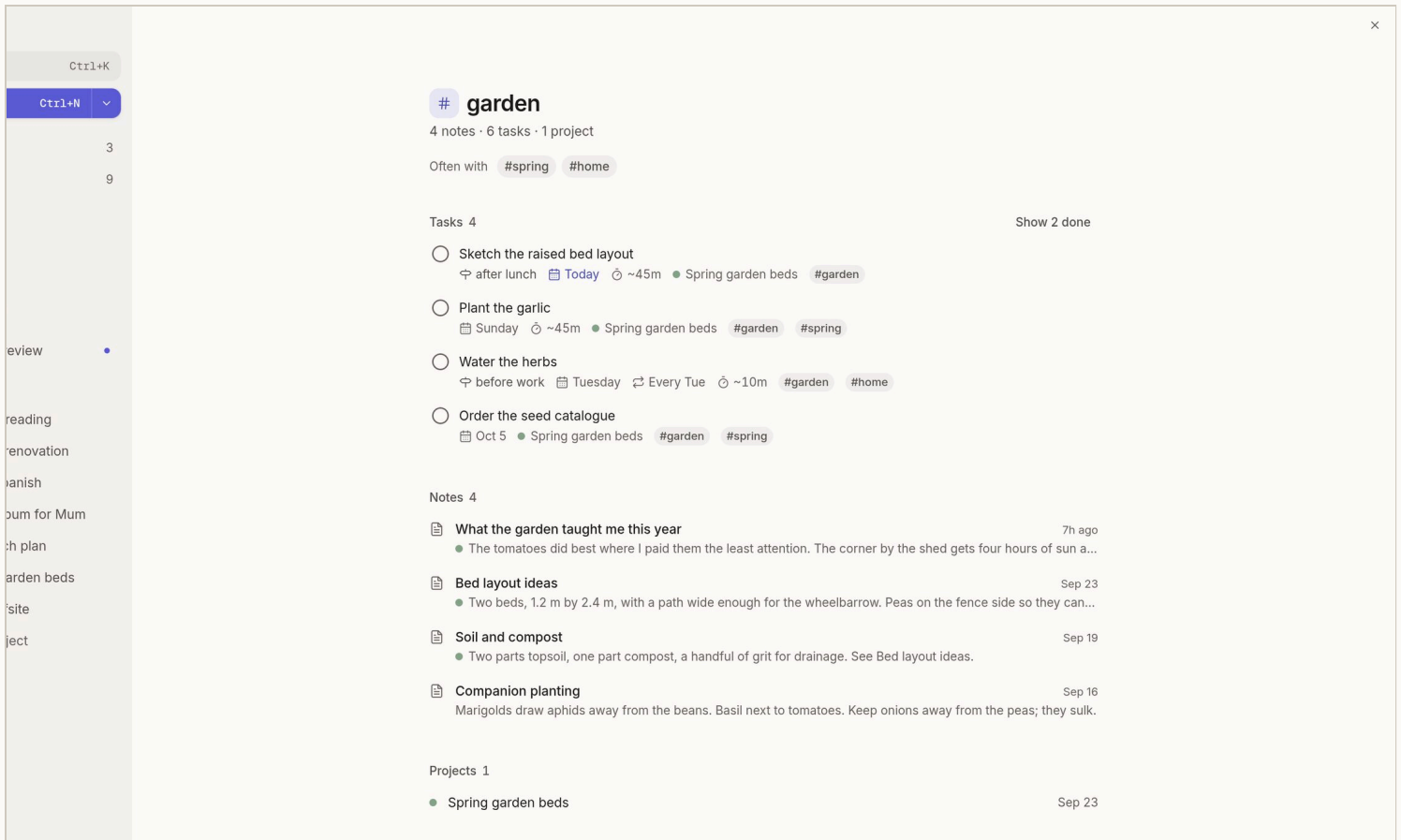
No. 13

HOW TO

Type `[]` in any note to open suggestions. Use Link beside any Unlinked mention at the foot of a page.

OPPOSITE

Typing `[]` opens suggestions ranked by match, with Create “...” when nothing fits.



No. 14

NOTES AND KNOWLEDGE TAGS AND FILTERS

Hashtag, Finally Useful

Every tag gets a page. Notes gets filters. A tag you add is now a way back to what you wrote.

In 2.0 you could add tags to anything and use them to find nothing. The walkthrough searched `%K` for “#family” and got “Nothing matches”. There was no tag view and no way to filter Notes by tag or by project.

Now each tag has its own page at `/tags/<tag>`. The header counts what it holds,

for example “3 notes · 2 tasks · 1 project”, and the page lists Tasks, Notes, and Projects in turn. A row labelled **Often with** shows the tags that tend to travel alongside it. Typing `#tag` in the palette goes straight there.

The Notes list gains four filter chips: **Project**, **Tag**, **Area**, and **Kind**. Kind includes Journal, the only way journal pages appear in

Notes. A # button in the Notes header opens the **Tags** list, most used first, with counts.

None of this adds a new place to maintain. Tags remain ordinary `tags` in each file’s frontmatter, readable in any editor, and every view is computed from them on demand.

HOW TO

Type `#tag` in the palette (`%K`) to open a tag’s page. In Notes, use the Project, Tag, Area, and Kind chips, or the # button for the Tags list.

ABOVE

A tag page lists everything tagged, with related tags under Often with.

Review

1 of 4

Companion planting

Marigolds draw aphids away from the beans. Basil next to tomatoes. Keep onions away from the peas; they sulk.

How well did you remember it?

Again 1
Tomorrow

Hard 2
19 days

Good 3
35 days

Easy 4
70 days

No. 15

NOTES AND KNOWLEDGE RECALL

What Do You Remember?

Spaced review for the notes you choose. The title first, your own words next, and never a backlog.

Recalling something beats rereading it. The behavioral research rates retrieval practice as strong evidence, with effects around $g = .50$ in one meta-analysis and .61 to .70 in another, and spacing the attempts helps retention further. Most note apps are built for rereading. Recall is built for remembering.

On any note, choose **Review this note**. It comes back tomorrow, then at widening

intervals: 1, 3, 7, 16, and 35 days if you keep answering Good, stretching or shrinking with each answer.

The Review page shows the title first and a single question: “What do you remember?” An optional box invites you to “Put it in your own words first, if you like. This stays here and isn’t saved.” That is the generation effect, which the research also rates as strong. **Show note** reveals the body, and you answer **Again**,

Hard, **Good**, or **Easy**, each labelled with when the note will return.

The queue holds at most ten notes a day, and the rest roll forward quietly. There is no pile-up, no penalty for skipping, and the schedule lives in two readable frontmatter fields, `review` and `reviewInterval`.

HOW TO

On any note, choose Review this note in its properties. Open the queue with “Review notes” in the palette (⌘K) or Review in the Notes header.

ABOVE

A review card after Show note: the note revealed, then Again, Hard, Good, and Easy, each labelled with when the note will return.

Today

Close the day

New from template



Dates and the title fill in for you. Everything else is yours to write.

 Lecture notes

 Meeting notes

 Project brief

 Weekly plan

Weekly plan

Week of 2026-09-25

Priorities

Schedule

Notes

Title

Weekly plan

Create note

Pattern Pieces

Start from a shape you like. Headings only, no brackets to delete, and your dates filled in for you.

Templater is the second most downloaded plugin for Obsidian, at 5.7 million. The market research read that as demand for “Obsidian without the plugin tax”: the most-wanted plugin behaviours shipped as small, built-in defaults. Templates are one of them.

A template is an ordinary note stored in `templates/`, never shown in the Notes list. **New from template...** opens a picker with a live preview, a Title field, and **Create note**: “Dates and the title fill in for you. Everything else is yours to write.” `{{date}}`, `{{time}}`, and `{{title}}` expand when you use one.

There are four starters, added only when you ask with **Add starter templates**: Meeting notes, Lecture notes, Weekly plan, and Project brief. They hold headings only. That is a pointed choice. In 1.x, new projects wrote the literal placeholder “[What are you trying to change?]” into people’s files, and the guardrails now forbid placeholder text in files outright.

Any page can become a pattern. **Save as template** in its ... menu keeps its text for reuse, and templates can be edited or deleted in Settings.

No. 16

HOW TO

Choose New from template... in the sidebar’s New menu or the palette (). To make your own, choose Save as template in a page’s ... menu.

OPPOSITE

New from template, with a live preview of the Weekly plan starter. Its date is already filled in.

What the garden taught me this year

The tomatoes did best where I paid them the least attention. The corner by the shed gets four hours of sun and nothing else, and it gave us more fruit than the bed I watered every evening.

I planted too much, too close, too early. Every spring I believe the frost is over, and every spring it comes back for one more night. Next year the seedlings stay on the windowsill until the middle of May, whatever the forecast says.

The best hour of the day was the one after work, hose in hand, doing nothing that needed thinking. I want to keep that hour even in winter, even if all there is to tend is the rosemary.

Compost is slow, and that is the point. Half of what I learned this year was patience, and the other half was which slugs to forgive.

For the spring beds: fewer varieties, more of each. Peas, lettuce, the yellow courgettes Sam liked, and marigolds along the edges to keep the aphids busy.

LIGHT

What the garden taught me this year

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DARK

Nothing But the Page

One keystroke takes everything else away. The line you're writing stays centred; the rest of the page softens.

Interrupted people work faster, but they feel more stress, and the leftover attention from one task hurts the next.

The behavioral research rates those findings as moderate, and draws a design rule from them: no interruptions from the app.

Focus mode is that rule made visible. Press **⌘** and the sidebar disappears, the properties and top bar fade away, and Linked from and Unlinked mentions step aside. What remains is the page and a quiet **Exit focus** button with its Esc hint.

The caret line stays vertically centred as you write, typewriter style, so your eyes stay in one place. Other paragraphs soften to a fraction of their strength while the one you are writing in stays whole. If you prefer the page even, switch off **Dim other paragraphs** in Settings.

What focus mode does not have is as deliberate as what it does. There is no timer, no session count, and no focus score. The research suggested a plain countdown could at most be opt-in; 3.0 leaves it out. You leave when you are done, with Esc or the same keystroke.

No. 17

HOW TO

Press **⌘** (**Ctrl+** on Linux), choose Focus in a page's **⋮** menu, or run "Focus mode" from the palette. **Esc** exits.

OPPOSITE, LIGHT AND DARK

Focus mode in light and dark. The sidebar and properties gone, the paragraph being written at full strength, the others dimmed.

One more thing

What's this space for?

Pick the areas you'll use. They keep your files in tidy folders, and you can change them any time.



Work

Projects, meetings, and deadlines



Personal

Home, health, family, and errands



Learning

Courses, reading, and research



Creative

Writing, making, and side projects



Default for new things

Work

Personal

New notes and tasks go here unless their project has an area.

Skip for now

Continue

Tidy Folders, Plain Names

Tell myOS what the space is for, and your files arrange themselves the way you would have filed them. With names you can read.

The household organizer in the walkthroughs found family life filed under `work/`. Every capture landed there, because 2.0 kept a folder structure the interface never mentioned.

3.0 asks once, during onboarding: “What’s this space for? Pick the areas you’ll use. They keep your files in tidy folders, and you can change them any time.” The choices are **Work** (“Projects, meetings, and deadlines”), **Personal**, **Learning**, and **Creative**, with a default for new things. New notes and tasks take their project’s area, then the default. There is no more hidden `work/`.

Every page now has an **Area** property. Choosing another area moves the file to that area’s folder, keeps its name, takes a snapshot first, and offers Undo.

File names follow titles, too. About two seconds after you stop editing a title, the file is renamed to a readable `<slug>.md` in the same folder, with “-2” added if the name is taken. The rename is revision-checked, undoable, and never happens while you are still typing. Existing files keep their names until you edit their titles, and one switch in Settings turns the behaviour off. A folder you open in any other app should make sense on its own.

No. 18

HOW TO

Choose areas during onboarding, change the Area property on any page, and find “Keep file names in sync with titles” in Settings → Areas and files.

OPPOSITE

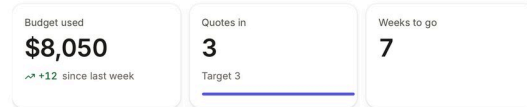
Onboarding’s second question: What’s this space for? Work, Personal, Learning, and Creative.

Kitchen plan

● Kitchen renovation · 24 September 2026 · Personal

The wall between the kitchen and the dining room comes down in November. This page keeps the plan, the budget, and the open questions in one place.

Where things stand



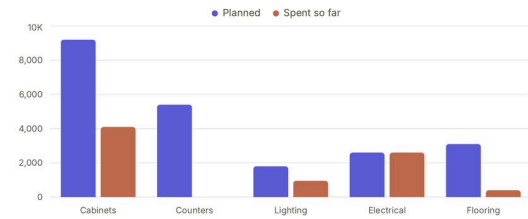
Cabinets are ordered and the electrician is booked for the second week. Counters wait on the final layout, which depends on where the sink ends up.

⚠ Before demolition

Confirm the wall is not load-bearing with the structural engineer. The permit needs her letter.

Budget

Budget by room



Item	Supplier	Lead time
Cabinets, sage green	Nordwood	6 weeks
Quartz counters	Stone & Co	3 weeks
Pendant lights	Lumen Studio	10 days

Sequence



This week

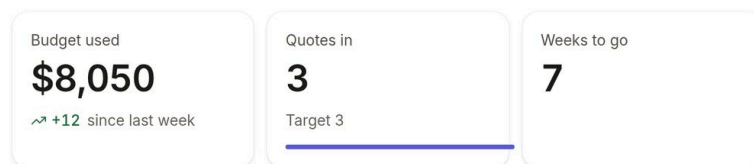
- ☒ Sign-off on the cabinet layout
- ☒ Book the electrician for the new circuit
- ☐ Pick the cabinet finish (sage or oak)
- ☐ Ask Dana about the pendant spacing

Kitchen plan

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Where things stand



Cabinets are ordered and the electrician is booked for the second week. Counters wait on the final layout, which depends on where the sink ends up.

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Budget

Budget by room

● Planned ● Spent so far

Ready to Wear

Send a page to someone who has never heard of myOS, and it arrives looking the way it does in the app.

Y our notes are plain Markdown, which is perfect for you and not always perfect for the person you are sending them to. The market research listed export and sharing among the table-stakes gaps, pointing to Bear's seven export formats as a praised strength.

A page's ... menu now offers four ways out. **Export as PDF...** and **Export as HTML...** open the native save dialog. The HTML is a single self-contained file, with images inlined and the bundled fonts embedded, so it reads the same on any

machine. **Copy as rich text** pastes cleanly into mail and documents, and **Copy as Markdown** gives you the source.

Exports are always rendered in the light theme, with the app's own reading styles. Charts stay crisp as SVG. The PDF picks its paper size from where you are, Letter in the United States and a few other countries and A4 elsewhere, and a toast offers **Show in folder** when it is done.

Nothing is uploaded. Export writes a file where you choose, and only where you choose.

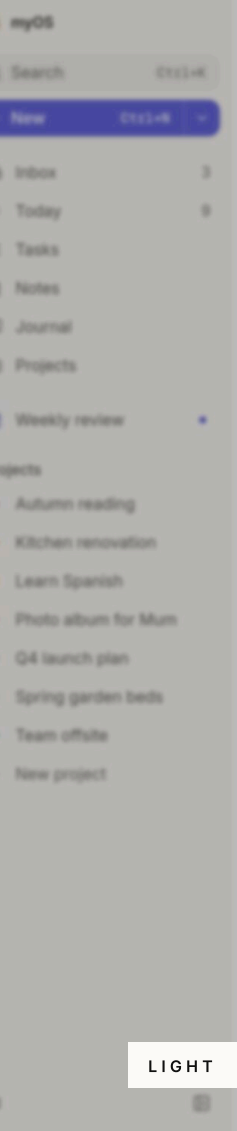
No. 19

HOW TO

Open a page's ... menu and choose Export as PDF..., Export as HTML..., Copy as rich text, or Copy as Markdown.

OPPOSITE

The same page exported as PDF (left) and as a single self-contained HTML file (right).



Version history

"Launch plan" - A copy is kept each time you save, at most every ten minutes, for sixty days.

Yesterday 15:30
497 bytes

Mon 21 Sep 09:05
472 bytes

Tue 15 Sep 16:40
401 bytes

Wed 9 Sep 10:12
330 bytes

Mon 21 Sep at 09:05
Compared with now **+3 -3**

2 unchanged lines

Owners

- - Copy: me

+ - Copy and the announcement email: me

- Pricing page: Maya

- - Press: Priya

+ - Press: Priya, with the [[Press list]]

Open questions

1 unchanged line

- [] Confirm the date with sales

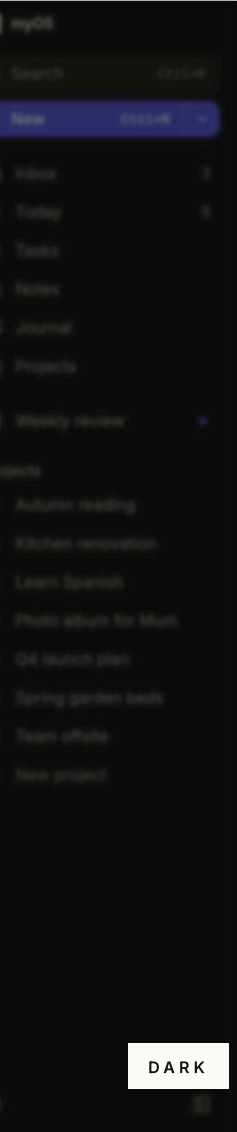
- [] Decide on the waitlist cap

- [] Agree on the holiday freeze

+ - [x] Agree on the holiday freeze

Restore this version

LIGHT



Version history

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Open questions

1 unchanged line

- [] Confirm the date with sales

- [] Decide on the waitlist cap

- [] Agree on the holiday freeze

+ - [x] Agree on the holiday freeze

Restore this version

DARK

Every Earlier Draft

Quiet snapshots of every page, kept outside your folder, with a readable comparison and a way back.

The Git plugin for Obsidian has 3.2 million downloads, and Obsidian Sync sells version history as a feature. People want a way back. Most would rather not run version control to get one.

In 3.0, every save keeps a copy of the page as it was just before, at most one every ten minutes per file. myOS also takes a copy, regardless of the ten-minute limit, before every delete, retype, rename, area move, and restore. The latest 50 copies of each file are kept, and anything older than sixty days is pruned.

The copies live in the app's own data folder, keyed to your workspace. They are never written into your folder, so your Git history and your file tree stay exactly as clean as you left them. When a file is renamed or moved, its history follows it.

Version history... in a page's ⋮ menu lists the copies by day and time. Choose one to see a readable diff, “Compared with now”, with lines added and removed. **Restore this version** is revision-checked, snapshots the current text first, and can be undone. Nothing is ever lost by looking back.

No. 20

HOW TO

Choose Version history... in a page's ⋮ menu, or run “Version history” from the palette ().

OPPOSITE, LIGHT AND DARK

Version history. Earlier copies on the left; on the right, a readable diff compared with now, and Restore this version.

Leaving things alone
always works.

GUARDRAIL NO. 2 · NO LOSS FRAMING

COLOPHON

Made *locally.*

TYPEFACES

Bodoni Moda for display, a Didone drawn for screens by Owen Earl.

Newsreader for text, by Production Type.

Inter for captions and labels, by Rasmus Andersson. It is also the face of myOS itself.

TOOLS

Written in Markdown in plain files. Set in HTML and CSS, paginated and printed by headless Chromium, with images prepared by ImageMagick. The screenshots are of myOS 3.0, in its light and dark themes.

SOURCES

Every fact in this issue comes from the overhaul's own record, the 3.0 plan, its three research briefs, the decision records in the owner's workspace, and the app's source.

ETHOS

Made locally. No telemetry. No account, no sync service, no bundled AI. The whole issue rebuilds from its Markdown with one command.

CREDITS

The myOS Editors.

myOS

Your files
will still open
in 2046.

myOS

Notes, Tasks, Projects, Inbox. Plain Markdown in a folder you choose.
macOS and Linux. No account. No sync service. No telemetry. No bundled AI.

ISSUE 03 · AUTUMN 2026 · THE CALM ISSUE